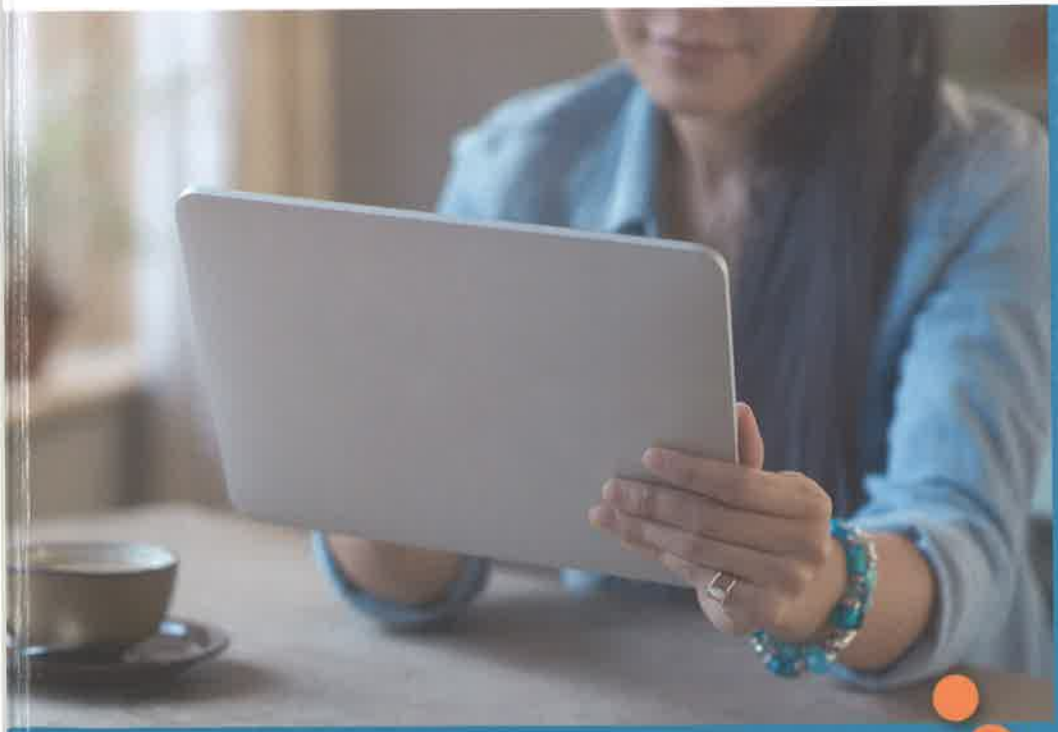
Updated edition of the best-selling title

Paul Emmerson

email English

2nd Edition



With new social media section and phrase bank of useful expressions

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To the student

Who is this book for?

Learners of English at intermediate or upper-intermediate level who want to write better emails. It can be used by learners studying on their own, or with a teacher.

Why should I buy this book?

Emails are written quickly and no-one minds if you make mistakes. So why study them in a book? Well, it's true that an informal email doesn't have to be in perfect English. But how do you get the tone right, so you sound friendly? And what about an email where you want to make a good impression? Or where you want to be more diplomatic than usual? Or an email in a professional/work context?

It takes awareness and practice to write in a style that fits the situation, and *Email English* has many exercises to help you do this. If you work through *Email English* you will be able to express yourself more clearly, you will create a good image, and your writing will be easier to understand. Other people will want to know you better, as a friend, colleague or business partner.

How is the book organized?

Email English consists of:

- Thirty-two units of language practice. These cover a wide range of topics, and include a great variety of exercise types (all the answers are at the back).
- A phrase bank. Use this as a reference when you write your own emails.
- A Social Media supplement. This has tips and techniques for writing online, using platforms such as Facebook, LinkedIn, etc.

Quick tips for writing effective emails

Here are some tips for writing good emails:

- Use a 'subject line' that summarizes the content of the message. You want people to find your email easily in their folders later. So 'From John' is not a good subject line.
- Use short, simple sentences. The most common mistake for learners of English is to translate directly from their own language. Usually the result is a complicated, confusing sentence.
- One subject per email is best. The other person can reply to an email about one thing, delete it, and leave another in their inbox for later.
- If you are angry, wait for 24 hours before you write. Once you press 'Send' you cannot get your email back. Only write what you would be comfortable saying to the person's face.
- Consider layout. Would some of the continuous text be better as bullet points or numbered points? How about putting action points in bold?
- Don't ignore capital letters, punctuation, spelling, paragraphs, and basic grammar. In a professional context, a careless, disorganized email shows a careless, disorganized mind.
- In your reply, try to match the tone and style of the other person. Also, look for key words from their company culture, or professional area, and 'echo' these back to them.

To the teacher

How can I use *Email English* in class?

You can do any number of units, in any order. There is no 'free' writing practice in the book as *Email English* is designed for self-study as well as classroom use. But if you do want to set a writing activity at the end of a unit, then you can find some suggested tasks here:

www.businessenglishonline.net/resources/email-english-worksheets

There are tasks for both working professionals and for university students. The tasks allow a high degree of personalization.

Organizing a writing task in class

A time limit or word limit will help to focus the activity. Then, while the students write, circulate, noting down any points of general interest and dealing with them at the end in a feedback slot. When students finish writing they can either hand in their work to you for marking, or work in pairs to improve each other's work, or you can stand at the front and build up a 'collective best version' on the board. Let's look at each option in more detail:

1 **Teacher marks the students' work**. This is the best known technique: you simply underline the mistakes and then write in the correct form. But there are variations. You can underline but with no correct form given, and then ask students to try to correct themselves. Or you can write a comment in the margin, next to the appropriate line. For example, you might write 'verb tense', 'preposition', 'word order' or 'formality'. And don't forget to acknowledge good use of language in your feedback. It is very motivating for the student to get a comment in the margin such as 'Good use of this phrase', or 'Very well written, a big improvement'.

2 **Students work in pairs to correct and improve each other's work.** Students learn a lot by reviewing a partner's work. They can often spot things that they cannot spot in their own writing, both good and bad. Peer correction helps change the classroom atmosphere from a silent writing task to something more lively and communicative.

3 **Collective best version on the board.** Try this method if all the students have been doing the same task and the content of their emails is similar. Go through the email sentence by sentence. Each time, ask one or two students to suggest an idea and then everyone (including you) can comment on and improve the ideas. Build up an agreed version bit by bit on the board. Keep the pace quick and lively.

Finally, two important points:

- Consider the idea of repeating a task in a later lesson. The students use the same instructions and then write the same email again (without looking at their first attempt). The importance of repeated practice of this kind is often underestimated by teachers who think it might be boring for students. Students, however, recognize that it helps build fluency in writing.
- Look for opportunities in class for students to 'send' and reply to emails to each other.

1 Formal or informal?

A First, read the information about email writing styles.

It is helpful to think about three writing styles, although in real life the differences are not so clear.

Formal This is the style of an old-fashioned letter. Ideas are presented politely and carefully, and there is much use of fixed expressions and long words. Grammar and punctuation are important. This style is not so common, but you can find it if the subject matter is serious (for example a complaint), in emails to customers where you want to make a good impression, or in some cultures where a more formal style is expected.

Neutral This is the most common style in professional/work emails. The writer and reader are both busy, so the language is simple, clear and direct. There is often a friendly opening line. Sentences are short and there is use of contractions (*I've* for *I have* etc.).

Informal This is the style for emails between friends. The email might include personal news, funny comments etc. This style is close to speech, and has informal words and conversational expressions. Many people now choose social media rather than email to communicate with friends: with social media the style is even more informal.

Most real emails are basically neutral, but with some elements of formality or informality depending on the context. Mixing styles is okay to some extent, but don't mix styles at the two extremes.

Now match the more informal phrases (1–16) with the more formal phrases (a–p).

Informal	Formal
1 What do you need? d	a) Unfortunately I will not be able to attend the meeting.
2 Thanks for your email.	b) I can assure you that …
3 Sorry, I can't make it.	c) I will take the necessary action to solve this issue.
4 Could you …?	d) Please let us know your requirements.
5 I promise …	e) I was wondering if you could …?
6 You haven't …	f) We regret to advise you that …
7 I'm sorry to tell you that …	g) Thank you for your email of 12 February.
8 I'll deal with this.	h) We note from our records that you have not …
9 Don't forget that …	i) I look forward to meeting you next week.
10 I need to …	j) With reference to … (*or* Regarding …)
11 Shall I …?	k) Would you like me to …?
12 But … / Also … / So …	l) I would be grateful if you could …
13 Please …	m) Please accept my apologies for …
14 I'm really sorry about …	n) It is necessary for me to …
15 Re …	o) We would like to remind you that …
16 See you next week.	p) However … / In addition … / Therefore …

B **Match the more formal words in box A with the more informal words in box B.**

A

1 ~~assistance~~	5 inform	9 possess
2 due to	6 information	10 provide
3 in the near future	7 receive	11 request
4 further	8 occupation	12 requirements

B

a) soon	e) job	i) give
b) facts	f) because of	j) needs
c) ~~help~~	g) get	k) have
d) ask for	h) more	l) tell

1 *c* 2 ..... 3 ..... 4 ..... 5 ..... 6 ..... 7 ..... 8 ..... 9 ..... 10 ..... 11 ..... 12 .....

Note there are often two words in English with a similar meaning: a longer one of Latin or Old French origin that is more *formal*, and a shorter one of Old English origin that is more *informal*.

C **Rewrite the formal emails below by replacing the phrases *in italics* with more informal phrases. Sections A and B will help you. Use contractions (eg *I'll* for *I will*) where appropriate.**

Email 1

Unfortunately I will not be able to attend the meeting on Friday. As *I will* miss the meeting, *I was wondering if you could* send me a copy of the minutes? *I will* write to Rina as well, to *inform* her that I *will not* be there. Once again, *please accept my apologies for* this.

Sorry I can't make it on Friday. As I'll miss the meeting,

Email 2

Thank you for your email of 25 January where you *requested assistance* on how to *receive* an online discount. *It is necessary for me to* know your a/c number before I can *take action to solve this issue. I would be grateful if you could* also let me know which browser *you are* using.

Email 3

I am writing *with reference to* your order number 8916. We *received* the order this morning via our website, but you *have not* filled in the section about size. *Please let us know your requirements.* These products are selling very well, and *we regret to advise you that* the medium size is temporarily out of stock. *However, we are* expecting more to arrive *in the near future. Would you like me to* email you when they are back in stock?

2 Key phrases

A Write a subject line from the box for each email. One is not used.

Action re contract	Your order #8694: out of stock items	Meeting 14/5
Re your advertisement	Shipping confirmation	Special deals for January!

Email 1

Subject: .....

Re your last email, we are in the process of arranging the meeting scheduled for 14 May, but there are still a few details I need from you. Do you want me to book hotel accommodation for you — or will you sort it out at your end? Also, can you send us something about the Barcelona project you were involved in last year? It would be helpful to have something to circulate before the meeting. Please send a copy of any relevant reports. Regards, Monica.

Email 2

Subject: .....

Sorry for the delay in replying — I've been out of the country on business. Unfortunately, the items you ordered are not in stock, but we're expecting delivery by the end of the week. I'll get back to you as soon as they arrive. If you need any more information, please feel free to contact me.

Email 3

Subject: .....

Luisa, I've emailed Michelle and Roberto about the changes to the contract. If you like, I can have a word with Michelle to make sure she understands what's going on. And, as you work with Roberto, can you talk to him? Thanks for your help.

Email 4

Subject: .....

Good news! Subscribers to this email newsletter can take advantage of fantastic price savings in our January sale. I've attached a pdf file that gives full details, or alternatively just click on the link below. You can order online or by phone — our customer service staff are always available to answer questions. Looking forward to hearing from you soon.

Email 5

Subject: .....

Just a short note to let you know that we received your order. I can confirm that the items were sent by courier today. To track your order, click on the link below. If there's anything else, just let me know. Best wishes, Pierre.

B **Complete the table by matching an underlined phrase in section A with a similar phrase below. Look carefully at the headings in bold.**

Previous contact		
With reference to your email sent (date), …	1	*Re your last email …*
Reason for email		
We are writing to inform you that …	2	
Good news		
You will be pleased to hear that …	3	
We are able to confirm that …	4	
Bad news/Apologizing		
I apologize for …	5	
We regret to inform you that …	6	
Requests		
I'd be grateful if you could …	7	
I would appreciate it if you could …	8	*Can you …*
Offering help		
Would you like me to …?	9	
If you wish, I would be happy to …	10	
Promising action		
I will contact you again.	11	
Attachments		
Please find attached …	12	
Final comments		
Thank you for your assistance.	13	
Do not hesitate to contact us again if you need any further information.	14	
Closing		
We are looking forward to …	15	
Yours/Sincerely	16	/

C **In general, do you think the phrases on the left above are more *informal* or more *formal* than those on the right?**

Underline all the phrases above you already use in your emails.

3 Opening and closing

A **Match the email beginnings (1–8) with the endings (a–h).**

Beginnings ...	... Endings
1 I am writing with regard to your recent email. We regret to inform you that there are no double rooms available for the nights you require. ...*c*...	a) Anyway, really looking forward to it. Do u want me to bring anything?
2 Thank you so much for the wonderful present. It's exactly the book that I wanted – how did you know? I'm really looking forward to reading it.	b) You know you can count on me if you need any support. I'll call you at the weekend to see how things are.
3 Patricia, I've just read your email. I'm so sorry to hear about what happened.	c) Should you need any further information about room availability, we will be happy to assist you.
4 Aarrgghh! Can't make it. Really sorry. But I'm sure you'll all have a great time.	d) I look forward to receiving this information as soon as possible.
5 I am mailing this via the 'Contact Us' link on your website. I'd like to know a few more details about the anti-virus software that's listed on the site.	e) It really is great news, and I'm sure that it's only the beginning of our work in the French market.
6 I am writing with reference to our order number GH674. The goods arrived this morning, but you only sent 200 pieces instead of the 300 that we ordered.	f) Please deal with this matter urgently. I expect a reply from you by 5 pm tomorrow at the latest.
7 Wow! Great! I'd love to come!	g) Thanks again for the gift, and give my very best wishes to your family.
8 I've just heard from Antonio about the Paris contract. It's fantastic news – you worked really hard on this and you deserve the success.	h) Sorry again I can't come. ☹ But let's meet up soon anyway. What about going to see that new Ang Lee movie?

B Match the beginning and ending pairs in section A with the descriptions (1–8) below.

1 An email asking for information. Neutral style. 5d
2 An email giving information. Formal style. .....
3 An email saying 'yes' to an invitation. Informal style. .....
4 An email saying 'no' to an invitation. Informal style. .....
5 An email of congratulations. Neutral style. .....
6 An email of complaint. Neutral style. .....
7 An email of thanks. Neutral style. .....
8 An email of sympathy. Informal style. .....

C Read the following sentences. Decide whether they are *beginnings* or *endings*. Then decide whether they are more *formal* or more *informal*.

1	I hope that everything is clear now, but do not hesitate to contact me if you need any clarification.	beg/(end)	(form)/inf
2	Btw, I'll be back late. Can you do the shopping and buy something nice for dinner? Thx. Cu later.	beg/end	form/inf
3	This email is to inform all staff that the computer network will be shut down for maintenance over the weekend.	beg/end	form/inf
4	Meg! What a surprise! How nice to hear from you! How are things?	beg/end	form/inf
5	I look forward to receiving your comments on this matter.	beg/end	form/inf
6	I think that's all for now. Will keep you updated. Am on ext 391 if you have any Qs. Cheers, Lukas.	beg/end	form/inf
7	Dear colleagues – I thought it was a very useful meeting on Friday. Please find attached my report, as promised.	beg/end	form/inf
8	Anyway, I'm so happy for you! You really deserve this. Write again soon and tell me how it's going.	beg/end	form/inf
9	Hey Lara. Been talking about hols with S. Looks like we won't b able to join u. Really sorry.	beg/end	form/inf
10	We are writing to advise you of some changes in our price list.	beg/end	form/inf
11	If you would like any more details, please let me know. I am away next week but Andrea is dealing with this in my absence.	beg/end	form/inf
12	Just a quick note to say I really enjoyed last night.	beg/end	form/inf

D Look back at the examples in section C. Find:

a) two written to a long list of people who are unknown or little known. 3 /.....
b) five written to known colleagues at work. 1 /...../...../...../...../.....
c) four written to friends. ...../...../...../.....
d) one written to a very close family member. .....

4 Giving news

A Decide whether the following would be used in a more *formal* or more *informal* email.

1 Further to our phone call, I now have the information you requested. form/inf
2 Thx for your email – great to hear from you again. form/inf
3 Sorry I haven't been in touch. Really busy with all kinds of stuff. form/inf
4 With reference to your last email, I am writing to let you know … form/inf

B Rewrite the sentences below with the correct word order, beginning as shown.

1 I'm writing our appointment 6 June on Tuesday to confirm.
I'm .....
2 Hey Max. You'll guess never happened what's!
Hey Max. You'll .....
3 You will pleased be to hear that has been successful your application.
You .....
4 Unfortunately, I will make the meeting not be able to on 6 June Tuesday.
Unfortunately, ...
5 We inform you regret to that your application has been not successful.
We .....
6 Just a quick note everything's good for our trip to say that at the weekend.
Just .....
7 Here's the project on an update.
Here's .....

C Look back at the sentences in section B. Find:

a) two written by a friend to another friend. ..... /.....
b) two written by a professional to a client, about a meeting. ..... /.....
c) two written by a human resources manager to a candidate for a job. ..... /.....
d) one written by a professional to a colleague, introducing work information. .....

D Complete the emails by writing *one* word in each gap. Several answers may be possible.

(1) *Further* to our phone call earlier today, I'm writing to (2) ..... that I am able to (3) ..... the meeting next Monday as discussed. Looking (4) ..... to seeing you then.

With (5) ..... to your last email, I am writing to (6) ..... you know what's happening with the project. Everything is fine, but (7) ..... we are a little behind schedule. You can get the whole story from my report, which I've (8) ..... as a pdf.

E Match the situations (1–6) with the verb forms in *italics* (a–f) below.

1 giving news: describing a habit or routine *b*
2 giving news: present result of a past action .....
3 giving news: action in progress at the moment (temporary) .....
4 giving news: action in progress from the past up to the present .....
5 background to a story: action in progress in the past .....
6 event in a story: completed action in the past .....

a) Hi Anna. I'm in Switzerland! I'*m working* as an au pair over the summer.
b) I have a new job! The hours aren't too bad – I *start* at 9 and *finish* around 5.
c) Things are going well for me. I'*ve found* somewhere to live and I'*ve bought* a car.
d) You won't believe it! I *was shopping* in the city centre the other day and I saw Helga! She …
e) You won't believe it! I was shopping in the city centre the other day and I *saw* Helga! She …
f) Do you fancy going out on Friday? I'*ve been working* real hard all week and I need to relax.

F Read the email. Then choose the best word to fill each gap from a, b, c or d below.

Hi Angela, thanks for your email. I (1) *d* from you for ages! Was it really a year ago that we (2) ..... at the English Centre? Do you know, I've already (3) ..... the name of our teacher! Anyway, I'm pleased to hear that you're still enjoying your job, and that your relationship with Carlos (4) ..... well.

I've been really busy. For the last few months (5) ..... at a wine bar. I start work at six every evening, and (6) ..... until midnight. I'm trying to save some money to go to Thailand, but I haven't got enough (7) ..... .

I'm really enjoying it now, although at first it (8) ..... difficult. It's real crazy – so many people ordering things at the same time.

By the way, I (9) ..... to Manuela on the phone the other day and she (10) ..... you might come over here for a visit. Please do come – you know you're always welcome to stay at our house.

Anyway, that's all for now. Are you on Skype? Let's fix a time to chat.

1	a) have heard	b) don't hear	c) did hear	d) haven't heard
2	a) have been	b) did be	c) were	d) are
3	a) forget	b) forgot	c) forgotten	d) been forgetting
4	a) is going	b) goes	c) went	d) go
5	a) I work	b) I had worked	c) I worked	d) I've been working
6	a) I don't leave	b) I'm not leaving	c) I haven't left	d) I'm not going to leave
7	a) already	b) still	c) yet	d) soon
8	a) has been	b) had been	c) was	d) is
9	a) talk	b) have talked	c) have been talking	d) was talking
10	a) mentions	b) mentioned	c) has mentioned	d) has been mentioning

5 Advice and suggestions

A **Read the email exchange between two friends. Sandra asks Nouf for advice.**

Hi Nouf. Hope you're well.
You know I'm doing that secretarial course? Well, (1)*there's something on my mind, and maybe you can help.* I know you were in a similar situation last year. The thing is, the course is really boring and I hate it. But I've already paid for it, and it runs till the end of June. What do you think I should do? (2)*Any ideas?* Thanks for taking the time to help me on this – I always appreciate your advice. (3)*Please let me know what you think – email me or give me a call.*
All the best,
Sandra

Hey Sandra! Great to hear from you!
I'm good. Same old stuff – work, music. I'm really into a band called The Virals – ever heard of them?
(4)*I'm really sorry you're having such a hard time at the moment.* But being honest (5)*I think you should* finish the course. You only have a few months to go. There's always stuff in a course like that which comes in handy later, like increasing your typing speed.
If you're desperate, then (6)*what about* going to a careers advice centre? It might help to talk to someone there. (7)*I think it's better than* giving up the course and doing nothing. Or maybe do something crazy, like travelling around India for a year. That way, you could think about what you want to do with your life.
(8)*Hope that helps*, but you have to decide in the end!
Cheers,
Nouf

Now match the phrases in *italics* above (1–8) with the phrases (a–h) below.

a) I would appreciate it if you could contact me to discuss this matter further. .....
b) I think it might be a good idea to … .....
c) I was wondering if you had any ideas. .....
d) have you thought of … (+ *-ing*) .....
e) I'd like your advice about a problem I have. ...1...
f) I hope I have been of some help. .....
g) I think this option would be preferable to … (+ *-ing*) .....
h) I was sorry to hear about your current difficulties. .....

B **In general, do you think phrases a–h are more *formal* or more *informal* than those in the emails above? Try reading the two emails aloud, first in their original version, then with a–h instead. It will help you to understand what happens if the style is not appropriate.**

C Each phrase below has two words the wrong way round. Correct the mistakes *this like*.

Asking for advice

Opening:	1	There's something on my mind, and maybe can you help.
Asking for advice:	2	What I should do? I was wondering if you had any ideas.
Closing:	3	Please let know me what you think.

Giving advice

Opening:	4	I'm sorry you're having a such hard time at the moment.
Giving advice:	5	I think might it be a good idea to finish the course.
Result:	6	This would mean could you think about what to do with your life.
Options:	7	I think this option would preferable be to giving up the course.
Closing:	8	I hope have I been of some help.

D Match the beginnings of the sentences (1–12) with the endings (a–i).

Making a suggestion

1 I think we should ..*a*...
2 I suggest .....
3 Shall we .....
4 Perhaps we could .....
5 How about .....
6 Why don't we .....
7 Let's .....

a) go to an Italian restaurant.
b) go to an Italian restaurant?
c) going to an Italian restaurant.
d) going to an Italian restaurant?

Accepting/Rejecting a suggestion

8 Great! What a .....
9 Yes, good idea. I think it would .....
10 Yes, that might be .....
11 Your idea sounds good, but .....
12 I'm not so .....

e) work really well.
f) I'm not sure it would work in practice.
g) wonderful idea!
h) sure about this. I can see some problems.
i) worth trying. Let's give it a go.

E Complete the sentences by writing *one* word in each gap.

1 I was ..... if you ..... give me some advice.
2 Please ..... me know what you think. I always ..... your advice.
3 I think you ..... finish the course. It's ..... than giving up.
4 What ..... going to a careers advice centre? It ..... be a good idea.
5 ..... we meet up for lunch one day next week to talk ..... it?
6 Yes, that might be ..... trying. It could ..... really well.

6 Invitations and directions

A Look at the phrases in *italics* in the three emails below. One phrase in each pair comes from a company with a formal culture, the other phrase comes from a company with an informal culture. Underline all the phrases from the formal company.

Email 1

(1)*Dear Natalia/Hi Natalia*
(2)*I'm writing to ask you/We would be very pleased if you could come* to a meeting here on 14 May. (3)*It has been arranged/I've arranged it* to bring together all our colleagues working in Eastern Europe (4)*to/in order to* share experiences about working in this market. (5)*Your attendance will be very welcome./It'd be great to see you.*
The meeting will last all day and will have an informal agenda – (6)*you won't need to/it will not be necessary to* write a report for it or make a presentation. (7)*Refreshments will be provided/There'll be plenty to eat and drink* during the day.
(8)*Hope to see you in May./Your presence at the meeting will be very useful.* Please let me know if you (9)*will be able to attend/can make it* (10)*asap/as soon as possible.*
Best regards, (11)*John Saunders/John*

Email 2

(12)*Thanks a lot for the invite/Thank you for your kind invitation.* (13)*I would be delighted to attend/I'd love to come to* the meeting. (14)*It sounds like a great idea/I am sure it will be very useful.* Please let me know if there's anything I can do to help from this end.
(15)*Will it be okay/Would it be possible* to bring Martina Rutka as well? She's a new member of our team and is very involved with the Eastern Europe market.
(16)*Thanks again/Thank you once more for your invitation,* and (17)*I look forward to seeing you/I'll see you* on 14 May.

Email 3

(18)*Just a quick note re your invite/I'm writing in relation to your kind invitation.* Unfortunately, I have another appointment on that day. (19)*I'm very sorry that I'll miss the meeting/Please accept my apologies for being unable to attend.*
In any case, send my regards to everyone at the meeting, and please (20)*let me have a copy of any report arising from the discussion/email me and let me know how it went.*
I hope (21)*we can meet up soon/we will have the opportunity to meet on another occasion in the near future.* Maybe Stuttgart in November?
(22)*Good luck with the meeting!/I am sure that the meeting will be a great success.*

B Complete the phrases by writing *one* word in each gap. Several answers may be possible.

1 We ..... be very pleased if you ..... come to a meeting here on 28 July.
2 Your ..... at the meeting will be very ..... . I hope you can ..... it.
3 Please ..... me ..... if you can attend, ... soon as possible.
4 Thank you for your ..... invitation. I would be ..... to attend. I look forward to ..... you on the 28th.
5 ....., I will not be able to come. I have another ..... on that day. Please accept my ..... .
6 I hope we will have the ..... to meet on another occasion in the ..... future. I am sure the meeting will be a great ..... .

C Put these sentences into the correct sequence to make one complete email. Read it aloud when you finish to check it makes sense.

a) Looking forward to meeting you next week.
b) Our office is close to the train station — the best thing to do is catch a taxi from the airport.
c) Just a note to confirm your visit to us on 16 Jan.
d) Best wishes, Atsuko.
e) When you arrive, ask for me at reception and I will come down and meet you.
f) If you need to contact me, my mobile number is 07968 243983.

1 ..... 2 ..... 3 ..... 4 ..... 5 ..... 6 .....

D Review some language for giving directions for an informal visit. Complete the email below by writing *one* word in each gap.

Hi Martin,
Here are the directions for how to (1) ..... to my house. You can print out this email and bring it with you. It's not difficult to find, as you're arriving (2) ..... train.
Come out of the station and (3) ..... right. Carry (4) ..... down the road (5) ..... you come to a church called St Paul's. You can't (6) ..... it. Just after the church turn left down Brittany Road. Be careful – people often go (7) ..... without noticing it. You'll see my house (8) ..... the end of the street – it's number 48, with a red door. Try and get here in time for lunch. Just (9) ..... me a call on your phone if you get (10) ..... . (11) ....., it's great that you're coming down for a few days.
Give my best (12) ..... to your family.
Jan

7 Checking understanding

A **Complete the email exchange between Peter and Kate by writing *one* word in each gap. In email 2 Kate has used the 'Reply' button, so she includes the text of the email she received.**

Email 1 (from Peter to Kate)

Kate, I've attached the sales figures for Q3, as requested.
You'll see that we're up 6%! Things are really taking off in Latin America.
By the way, are you going to the conference?

Email 2 (from Kate to Peter)

> Kate, I've attached the sales figures for Q3, as requested.
Sorry, Peter, you forgot to send the (1) _____. Can you send it again?
> You'll see that we're up 6%! Things are really taking off in Latin America.
Great news. But do you (2) _____ 6% increase for the quarter or 6% year on year?
> By the way, are you going to the conference?
(3) _____ conference? The sales conference in Istanbul in September or the Singapore Expo?

Email 3 (from Peter to Kate)

Sorry about that, Kate. Here it is again. (4) _____ me know if you get it.
I meant 6% for the quarter! Head Office are very pleased.
What do you mean 'Which conference?'!! I was talking about the sales conference of course. But are you (5) _____ it's in Istanbul? I thought they changed it to Bodrum.

Email 4 (from Kate to Peter)

Okay, I've got the attachment this time. But I can't open it! Can you (6) _____ you can open your original file?
I thought the conference was in Istanbul, but I may be (7) _____. I'll check and get (8) _____ to you. Anyway, I can't go this year – Cathy is going instead.

Before you look at the answers in the back of the book, here are all the words you need:

attachment	back	check	Let	mean	sure	Which	wrong

B **Rewrite the sentences below with the correct word order to make typical email phrases. Start each sentence with a capital letter.**

1 mean you to send this did? i don't want to open the attachment a virus in case it's got.
Did you mean to send this? I don't want to open the attachment in case it's got a virus.

2 about that are you sure? i thought was in Bodrum the conference.

3 i'll check and get you back to later today.

4 i don't this point understand sorry. can you in detail more explain?

5 i'm sure not what mean you by this. you could clarify?

6 i thought on Thursday was the meeting, but I wrong may be.

7 sorry, my last email forget. you're right. not Friday, it should Thursday be.

8 what was I meant we can't transfer until Monday the money. the situation this clarifies i hope.

C **The email below shows text from an original email that has a '>' symbol in front. The person replying has cut parts of the original to leave only the key points, and then added comments in *italics*. Complete the email by writing *one* word in each gap.**

> I've written down some thoughts about the Duratech project – they are (1) _____ as a Word doc. I'm circulating it to all managers. Let me (2) _____ what you (3) _____ .

You (4) _____ to send the attachment. Can you send it (5) _____ ?

> There are a couple of things I'd like you to focus on. First is the lead time.

I'm not (6) _____ what you (7) _____ by 'lead time'. The time before the project starts, or the time the project will take once it has started?

> Then there's the question of costs.

I may be (8) _____ , but I think Daniel produced some detailed figures on this. I'll check with him and (9) _____ back to you.

> And finally, scope. Are the deliverables clearly defined?

I thought they were defined very clearly. Can you explain in more (10) _____ what your concerns are?

> I'd like your comments by the end of next week at the latest.

Of (11) _____ , no probs. I'll (12) _____ them to you in a day or two.

8 Verb forms

A **Match a *form* in the left-hand column with a *meaning* in the middle column and a *grammar word* in the right-hand column.**

1 Sales *increase* every year.	a) Completed actions in a completed period of time.	past simple
2 Sales *are increasing* at the moment.	b) Actions or situations repeated regularly over a long period of time.	past continuous
3 Sales *have increased* by 5% this year.	c) Actions or situations in progress from the past up to the present.	present simple
4 Sales *have been increasing* rapidly this year.	d) Temporary actions or situations in progress now.	present continuous
5 Sales *increased* significantly last year.	e) Actions or situations in progress in the past.	present perfect
6 Sales *were increasing* all through last year.	f) A past event or situation that has a result in the present.	present perfect continuous

Note: remember that some verbs are not normally used in a continuous form. These include verbs of thinking (*doubt*, *know*, *understand*), the senses (*see*, *appear*), feelings (*want*, *hope*), possession (*belong to*, *contain*, *have*) and other verbs like *cost*, *depend on*, *mean*, *need*.

B **Write each time phrase in the column where it is used most often. (2) means the phrase can be written in *two* columns. (BrE) means British English and (AmE) means American English*.**

already (BrE) already (AmE) ~~at the moment (2)~~ every Friday in the old days
just (BrE) just (AmE) last week not … yet (BrE) not … yet (AmE)
nowadays (2) once a year one month ago over the last few months right now (2)
since so far this year when I was young

Present simple *(I do)*	Present continuous *(I am doing)*	Present perfect *(I have done)*	Past simple *(I did)*
at the moment	at the moment		

* A few time phrases like *just* and *already* are used with present perfect in BrE but past simple in AmE. This is not a strong rule and you can find both forms in both countries.

C Complete the email by putting the verb in brackets into the most likely tense. Choose from present simple (*I do*), present continuous (*I'm doing*) or present perfect (*I've done*). Use contractions where appropriate.

Every year around this time we (1) _____ (recruit) candidates for positions across the company. This week I (2) _____ (plan) that process, so I (3) _____ (need) an estimate of staffing requirements from every department. In recent years we (4) _____ (always/be able to) recruit the numbers asked for, but this year will be different. At the moment we (5) _____ (operate) in a difficult market, and sales (6) _____ (fall) considerably over the last 12 months. This (7) _____ (mean) that we have been forced to reduce our staffing costs. Of course I (8) _____ (hope) this situation will only be temporary.

D Continue as before, and use either British or American English. Choose from present simple (*I do*), present perfect (*I've done*) or past simple (*I did*).

I (1) _____ (just/receive) an email from our subsidiary in Russia. They (2) _____ (need) more brochures as they (3) _____ (give out) their entire stock over the last few months. They (4) _____ (have) a stand at the Moscow Trade Fair last week and (5) _____ (distribute) hundreds of brochures. Now they (6) _____ (want) us to send another 5,000 copies. I (7) _____ (already/contact) Sales to see if they have any spare, but I (8) _____ (think) we'll need some more. Can you get a quotation from the printers?

E Continue as before. Choose from present perfect (*I've done*), past simple (*I did*) or past continuous (*I was doing*).

Hi Isabel! Sorry I (1) _____ (not/be) in touch recently. Hope you're well. Guess what! The other day I (2) _____ (meet) Katia while I (3) _____ (wait) at the bus stop. Remember her? That girl from Russia who (4) _____ (be) in our English class last year. I almost (5) _____ (not/recognize) her because she (6) _____ (wear) a punk rock outfit and had green spiky hair!

F Continue as before. Choose from present perfect (*I've done*) or present perfect continuous (*I've been doing*).

Kim! Are you there? I (1) _____ (try) to call you all week and there's no answer! I couldn't email you because I (2) _____ (wait) to get my computer fixed. What's your news? (3) _____ (you/find) a job yet? As for me, I (4) _____ (decide) to get fit. Yes, really! I (5) _____ (eat) healthy food, and I (6) _____ (start) yoga classes as well. I (7) _____ (go) to yoga for a couple of weeks now and I'm really enjoying it.

9 Sentence building

A Read the information about sentence structure.

A simple affirmative sentence in English typically has the order Subject + Verb + Object:

This report	*will analyse*	*our current marketing strategy.*
Sub	Vb	Obj

There can be an adverb phrase as well, and it often comes at the end. Adverbs say how (*quickly*), where (*at our offices*) or when (*next week*) something happens. If we have several adverbs together, the usual word order is HOW – WHERE – WHEN. Look at these examples:

I	*am looking forward to*	*our meeting*	*in Munich*	*next month.*
Sub	Vb	Obj	Adv (where)	Adv (when)

Sales	*rose*	*by over 10%*	*in Hungary*	*last year.*
Sub	Vb	Adv (how)	Adv (where)	Adv (when)

Notice how 'rise' in the last example does not take an object. It is called an intransitive verb.

Now rewrite the sentences (1–4) below with the correct word order.

1 me You may remember . We business cards last week at the Trade Fair exchanged .

2 well is going Our advertising campaign . We should until June consider extending it .

3 about the availability of rooms in July to ask I am writing . I need for three nights a single room .

4 to see my parents I am going next weekend . for a long time I haven't them seen .

B Read the information on making complex sentences.

You can make complex sentences by combining simple ones:

I	*am sorry to say*	*I can't accept your invitation on this occasion*	*but*	*I*
Sub	Vb	Obj		Sub

hope to make	*another trip to Paris*	*when I have more time later this year.*
Vb	Obj	Adv (when)

- There are two main clauses here, joined by the linking word 'but'.
- The phrase *I can't … this occasion* is a full clause itself. It has a subject, verb, object and adverb.
- The phrase *I have … this year* is a full clause itself. It has a subject, verb, object and adverb.

Now rewrite sentences (1–5) with the correct word order.

1 I am writing I am coming to visit to let you know
next month that your offices in Moscow .

2 This will be in Eastern Europe part of a visit to all our subsidiaries that I am making .

3 to consult with you I will take the opportunity about our strategic plan
for Eastern Europe, which for some time we have been working on .

4 I would also like our production facility to visit while I am in Moscow,
and if there is time as well some of the local suppliers to that facility .

5 I will contact you again when I can travel the exact dates as soon as I know .

C **Put the lines in the emails below into the correct order. Read them aloud when you finish to check they make sense.**

Email 1

I am writing to thank you ...1...
The meetings were very productive, and I ...4...
As well as the business side of things, ...7...
The next time that you are in Munich ...11...
Please give my regards ...13...
it was a great pleasure to meet them all. ...15...
during my recent trip to Paris. .....
I really appreciated the time you took .....
am sure that they lay the basis for .....
to show me Notre Dame, and .....
for your hospitality .....
the wonderful meal that we had afterwards. .....
a good long-term business relationship. .....
it will be my pleasure to return your kindness. .....
to your colleagues in the Paris office, ...

Email 2

Thank you for taking the time to attend ...1...
As we mentioned in the interview, we had ...5...
While we were impressed with your interview, ...8...
that you have the necessary skills ...10...
We appreciate your interest in ...12...
to wish you every success in the future. ...15...
your application has not been successful. .....
an interview with us last week. .....
we did not feel .....
Unfortunately, we have to inform you that .....
many applicants for this position .....
and we would like to take this opportunity .....
and experience for the position. .....
and the standard of candidates was very high. .....
working with us, ...

10 Missing out words; abbreviations

A

Missing out words is common in emails. It happens where the people know each other well and the context is informal, or when the email is written very quickly in a busy working day.

Match the sentences (a–j) to their descriptions (1–5) below.

a) (That's a) Good idea!
b) (I) Think your idea is great.
c) (Have you) Ever been there?
d) (It) Sounds like fun!
e) (I'll) Speak to you later.
f) (I) Hope you're well.
g) Just read (the) email about relocation.
h) (Are you) Coming with us on Friday for a drink?
i) (I am) Looking forward to seeing you.
j) (It's a) Pity we missed you yesterday.

1 The subject *I* can be left out, especially with verbs like *hope*, *think*, etc. ..b.. /.....
2 The words *I am* / *I have* / *I will* can be left out when they are followed by a main verb. ...../.....
3 In a question, *Are you* / *Did you* / *Have you* can be left out. ...../.....
4 The subject *That* or *It* can be left out, often with a form of *be* as well. ...../...../.....
5 The word *the* can be left out. .....

B

There are 17 places where words are missing in this email. Put back the missing words.

It was a
(Great evening, wasn't it! Really enjoyed the meal, and nice to see Mary and Roger again. Had a chance to speak to Lucy yet? Don't worry if you haven't, will be seeing her tomorrow.

About next week – film you suggested sounds great. Been talking to some colleagues at work about it. Tuesday might be difficult. Perhaps Wednesday better? Let me know.

Sometime soon we need to talk about holiday plans for next summer. Things are still a bit uncertain at work. Might be possible to take two weeks off in July, but can't be sure.

Going to see my parents at weekend – looking forward to it. They live in Chichester. Ever been there?

Anyway, got to go now. Hope you're well.

See you next week.

Before you check in the Answer key, here are the words you need:

Have you (×2)	I (×4)	I'll	I'm (×2)	I've (×2)	It	it was	It was
a	the (×2)	would be					

C

The abbreviations below are often found in writing. Match (1–4) with meanings (a–d).

1 ie (*id est*) .....
2 eg (*exempli gratia*) .....
3 NB (*nota bene*) .....
4 PS (*post script*) .....

a) I am going to give an example.
b) I am going to explain what I mean using different words.
c) I am adding some information at the end that I forgot.
d) I want you to give special attention to this next point.

D If emails are written very quickly you often find abbreviated forms. Techniques include:

1 using a letter or number to represent a sound (*cu = see you, thx = thanks*)
2 making a short form of a common word (*yr = your, wd = would, re = regarding* or *in relation to*)
3 missing out letters completely if the word is obvious (*recd = received, pls = please*)
4 writing the first letters of a well-known phrase (*asap = as soon as possible, Bw = Best wishes*).

Write out the following emails in full.

Email 1

Subject: Yr order ref no KD654
Re yr order recd today, we can't supply the quant u need right now. Pls confirm asap if a part-delivery wd be acceptable, with the rest to follow later. Rgds, Wei.

Subject: Your order reference number KD654

Email 2

Subject: Thx for yr msg
Re your msg left on my v/mail — yes, I'm free 4 lunch Wed next wk. Btw, gd news about yr job interview. Hv 2 work now. CU, Jane.

Subject:

Email 3

Subject: Tech Support
Sorry I missed yr call. Re tech support, on the website we hv a Knowledge Base and extensive list of FAQs. Shd find what you want there. But if you do need to spk to sb, you can call me during normal wkng hrs. Bw, Alan.

Subject:

11 Common mistakes 1

A Correct the mistake in each sentence.

1 I am write with regard to your recent email. ..I am writing..
2 Please send me your comments until Friday at the latest. .....
3 I will be grateful if you could send me more information. .....
4 Please find attach my report, as promised in Friday's meeting. .....
5 Exactly! I am agree with you. .....
6 I hope we can to meet up soon. .....
7 I look forward to receiving this information so soon as possible. .....
8 I'm sorry I haven't written for ages, but I been really busy. .....
9 It will be more better for me if we meet on Tuesday rather than Monday. .....
10 Sorry, I don't can help you on this matter. .....
11 If you require any further informations, please do not hesitate to contact me. .....
12 I look forward to meet you next week. .....
13 I am really appreciate your kindness during my stay in London. .....
14 At the meeting we will discuss the follow points. .....
15 We note from our records that we have not received your payment still. .....

B Each phrase below has *one* word missing. Add the missing word, as in the example.

1 With reference ^to your email sent 6 June, …
2 Thank you sending me the pdf catalogue I requested.
3 We are writing to inform that …
4 We are able confirm that …
5 I apologize the delay.
6 I would appreciate if you could …
7 Please get back me if there's anything else.
8 What time would convenient for you?
9 If you like any more details, just let me know.
10 Anyway, that's all for now – I write again soon.
11 It was good to meet you the conference in Beijing.
12 I look forward to hearing you soon.
13 I've attached a copy the latest sales figures.
14 Thank you for the invitation visit your company.
15 With reference your inquiry via our website, I've attached all the information you need.

C Each *paragraph* in the emails below has *three* mistakes (including missing words). Find them and correct them.

Email 1

It was a pleasure to meet you in Budapest last week and I would like to thank you for your interest in our office products. You mentioned you were going visit Turkey soon, and when you come here I like to invite you to visit our factory just outside Istanbul. We would be very pleased to showing you round our new factory and modern production facilities.

As you would being our guest, we would of course arrange for you to stay in a good hotel and take you out to dinner. Please to let me know when you have finalized your travel plans. I look forward to see you in Turkey in the near future.

Email 2

You will all be aware that we been interviewing candidates for the position of Marketing Director. I am now pleased to inform that we have appointed an excellent candidate, Simone Verhart. Simone has worked in marketing for over 15 years and I am sure she will be a valuable member of team.

I would like to invite you a short lunchtime reception in Conference Room 2 next Tuesday 5 Feb where you will have chance to meet Simone on an informal basis. Refreshments will be available. Please let me know if you can come so that I can to estimate numbers.

Email 3

I am write re our order for 1,000 pieces of footwear, reference VK899. The money was transfer to your account on 23 January but we yet haven't received the goods. You promised in your email of 15 Dec that you would ship within seven days of a firm order.

I called your office this morning but the secretary told you were away until tomorrow (Thursday). This is now a very urgent matter. Please call me as soon you can and let me know what is happening. We have customers waiting for these pieces and the delay is causing us for to lose business.

Email 4

It has been brought to my attention that security in the building is not so good as it could be. You may be aware that one of our secretaries had her bag stolen yesterday. In the light of this, I would like to remember you to take care of your personal possessions at all times, particular at lunch times when there are fewer people in the offices.

I am preparing a report on how security could be improved, and I could be grateful for any suggestions that you have. Please email me with your ideas by the end of next week at the later. I am also discuss the matter with our reception staff to see if there are any procedures we can improve there.

12 Common mistakes 2

A

Underline the *one* correct form from the *three phrases in italics*.

1 Please *find attachment* / *find attached* / *see attached* my report. Hope it's useful. Comments please by the end of the week.
2 Here is my report. If there are any issues that need clarification, *please make me* / *please to let me* / *please let me* know.
3 I just got Violet's report. I'm *forwarding it* / *moving it* / *replying it* to you here – see below. Hope it's not too late. Comments directly to her please, and cc me.
4 Here's the link for various forms that you have to complete online. Please *make* / *take* / *pay* special attention to form A2 which will be needed for insurance purposes.
5 Please print off and complete the attached forms, and then sign them and return them to Viju in HR. She needs them by 3 June *at the latest* / *at the last* / *at last*.
6 As agreed, I'm sending the agenda and pre-meeting notes. Let me know if there's anything else we can do *from our part* / *on our side* / *by our way* before we meet.
7 I'm attaching the revised Business Plan. Please *note* / *look* / *attend* that several alterations to budgets and dates have been made – they are highlighted in red.
8 Please find attached my report. *Come back with me* / *Come back to me* / *Return to me* if there are any problems with deadlines, etc.
9 Please find attached my report. *Make me have any comments* / *Let me have what you think* / *Let me know what you think*.
10 Here is the draft itinerary for your trip to Australia in April. Please *control* / *check* / *prove* that I have included everything necessary.

B

Correct the *one* mistake in each email below. Informal short forms (like *Hope you like it* instead of *I hope you like it*, or *mtg* instead of *meeting*) are not mistakes.

1 Here's the report. Hope you like it. Took me two days to write!
2 Report attached like promised. Any probs – get back to me.
3 Oops. Forgot send the attachment! Here it is.
4 I'm sending the report as an attachment to this email. If it doesn't open, make me know.
5 Please check the attached document careful and let me know if you have any questions. Will be away in Turkey for a few days but back next week.
6 I'm returning your original document with my comments inserted with red.
7 Here's link to online survey I mentioned. It's needed for internal quality assurance. Please to complete it asap, and by Fri at the latest.
8 We are always trying to improve our customer services. I be grateful if you could complete a short survey about your recent pre-sales contact with our company. The link is below.
9 FYI, here's Leslie's report. Section 3.2 v interesting. What you do think?
10 Thx for sending me the report – I let you know what I think.

C Complete the emails by writing *one* word in each gap. There may be several possible answers.

Email 1

Please (1) ..... attached my report. (2) ..... it's not too late. (3) ..... me know if you have any questions.

Email 2

(4) ..... agreed, I'm sending the pre-meeting notes. Let me know if there's anything (5) ..... we can do on our (6) ..... before we meet.

Email 3

Sorry, I (7) ..... to send the attachment! (8) ..... it is. Please get (9) ..... to me if you can't open it.

Email 4

I (10) ..... be grateful if you (11) ..... complete the attached form, print and sign it, and then scan it and return it to me. Please (12) ..... that I have a new email address.

D Put a tick (✓) next to the correct phrase, a) or b).

1 a) Hi! I haven't heard from you since ages! .....
b) Hi! I haven't heard from you for ages! ✓

2 a) Anyway, the life is complicated sometimes! .....
b) Anyway, life is complicated sometimes! .....

3 a) Don't worry – I did it yesterday. .....
b) Don't worry – I have done it yesterday. .....

4 a) Here's the information about the software. .....
b) Here's the informations about the softwares. .....

5 a) The woman who deals with it is called Emma. .....
b) The woman which deals with it is called Emma. .....

6 a) I am very interesting in your new product. .....
b) I am very interested in your new product. .....

7 a) Although he'll probably say 'no', I'll ask him. .....
b) Although he'll probably say 'no', but I'll ask him. .....

8 a) Let's discuss about this at the meeting. .....
b) Let's discuss this at the meeting. .....

9 a) I don't know what is she doing. .....
b) I don't know what she is doing. .....

10 a) I'm doing it as soon as I can. .....
b) I'll do it as soon as I can. .....

11 a) I think so it is possible. .....
b) I think it is possible. .....

12 a) It's urgent – you must do it asap. .....
b) It's urgent – you must to do it asap. .....

13 a) I like your idea very much. .....
b) I like very much your idea. .....

14 a) I am agree with you. .....
b) I agree with you. .....

15 a) When I will arrive, I will call you. .....
b) When I arrive, I will call you. .....

13 Punctuation and spelling

A Review the rules for full stops, commas and capital letters.

A full stop (.) is used at the end of a sentence.

A comma (,) is used:

- like a brief pause in speech to make the sentence easier to read.
- to separate items in a list (except for the last two items where we use *and*).
- after many linking words that come at the beginning of a sentence (like *However*).
  Note: in modern emails commas are not usually used after first lines (like *Dear Mary*) or last lines (like *Best wishes*).

Capital letters (also called 'upper case' letters) are used:

- to begin a sentence.
- for names of people, places, events and organizations; for job titles; for nationalities.
- for calendar information like days, months, etc.

Now rewrite the email below, putting in a) capital letters, b) *four* full stops and c) *two* commas.

dear mr curiel
i am the commercial director for efb pharma a small biotech company based in warsaw i attended your talk at the medtech conference in zurich in november and we met briefly afterwards here is the information i said i would send including our latest annual report i hope it is of interest
best regards
magda kowalski

B Review the rules for apostrophes. Then rewrite the email at the top of the next page, putting in a) capital letters, b) apostrophes and c) *three* commas.

An apostrophe (') is used:

- in short forms to show that one or more letters have been left out.
- Before the possessive *-s* to show ownership or the relationship between people.

hi jean – how are you? thanks for your email about mr durand. in fact im meeting him on friday 16 march. were meeting in his brussels office and im a bit nervous about it because i dont speak french very well! hes the marketing director of the company and reports directly to the ceo. its going to be an interesting meeting and i havent been to belgium before so im looking forward to it. anyway ill be in touch when i get back.

C Review the rules for colons and semi-colons.

A colon (:) is used to introduce items in a list.
A semi-colon (;) is used to separate long items in a list, particularly if there are commas inside some items.

Now rewrite the email, putting in a) capital letters, b) apostrophes, c) *two* commas, d) *one* colon and e) *two* semi-colons.

Xiu Li – have you read hanifs report yet? i think its main conclusions are correct. this is basically what hes saying sales are flat and have been so for months theres no new product in the pipeline despite our large r&d budget and our sales reps are starting to become demotivated. i hope the management take it seriously.

D How good is your spelling? A spell-checker helps if you use it, but it doesn't pick up everything and it's quicker to get it right first time. Underline the spelling mistakes in the email and write the correction below. There are 30 incorrect words.

Hi Tim! Thanks for your email wich I recieved some time ago. Sorry I havn't replyed before now, but I've been realy busy. Actualy, it's good news – I've got a job! I went for loads of interviews and finaly I was sucessful I'm working for a small indipendent record company. The job is very intresting – I help to organize tours for the groups, make arangements for there accomodation in the cityes where they play, things like that. I've been doing it since the begining of Februry, and its grate – completly difrent to my old job working in a restarant! It's a good oportunity for me. Hopefuly, if the peopel in the company like me, I'll get more responsabilities and more mony. Then I coud even think about visitting you in Ingland! Anyway, keep in touch, and I look foward to seeing you soon.

1	*which*	7		13		19		25	
2		8		14		20		26	
3		9		15		21		27	
4		10		16		22		28	
5		11		17		23		29	
6		12		18		24		30	

14 Being brief and businesslike

A **Look at the differences in style between these two emails. Notice how version 2 uses the key words from version 1. The form and order of the words may be different.**

Version 1

Subject: My ideas following last Friday's meeting
In the attached Word document you'll find my thoughts about the marketing plan that we discussed in last Friday's meeting, and in particular my response to Jenny's points about needing a new type of packaging to appeal to a younger age group. I think she raised some important issues, and so I'm circulating my ideas on this to everyone involved. Please insert your comments in red in the attached document and email it back to me as soon as possible.

Version 2

Subject: Ideas for packaging
We need a new type of packaging – as we all agreed in the last meeting. My ideas are in the attached doc. Comments please asap.

Now read statements 1–4 and say whether they best describe version 1 or version 2 above.

1 The email is very direct, very brief, and typical of many business emails. *Version 1/2*
2 The email gives more context, and so might be better for people not in the meeting. *Version 1/2*
3 The action required by the reader is not 100% clear. More words might be better. *Version 1/2*
4 There may be too much in the email to write and read in a busy working day. *Version 1/2*

B **Rewrite the email below. The maximum length is 50 words, including the subject line. Some key words have been underlined to help you, but you may need to change their form and order.**

Subject: Confirmation of our meeting as discussed by phone
I'm writing regarding our phone call earlier this morning. It was a very useful discussion and I am much clearer now about your objectives. At the end of the call you suggested a time and place for our next meeting, namely the lobby of the Intercontinental Hotel in Bangkok at 2.00 pm on 7 February. You mentioned this time would be convenient for you because you will be staying at the hotel. I said I would email you to confirm the meeting. Well, for me the time and place is very good – I am free all afternoon. I look forward to seeing you there and I hope that in the evening you can be my guest for dinner at a restaurant in the neighbourhood of the hotel.

Subject: .....

.....

.....

.....

C **Cross out 20 words which are not necessary in this email.**

Many thanks for your email which I received yesterday. Tuesday at 10.30 is fine for me as my 9 am meeting will be finished by then. Can you send me the latest sales figures before the meeting? I look forward to seeing you there.

D **Underline the key words, then rewrite the email. The maximum length is 60 words, including the subject line.**

Subject: Info re market developments in the Baltic States

Many thanks for getting in touch last week and sending me all the information about market changes in the Baltic States. It was really useful, particularly the graphs about expected demand for consumer products over the next five years. I've forwarded your email to our representative in Estonia, Krista Kilvet. She has just taken over from Doris Kareva, who I think you met in Stuttgart. Would you be interested in giving a presentation at our Head Office on the whole economic and business background in the region? I'm sure the Board would be interested as we may be making some large investments there in the near future.

Subject: .....

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E **Underline the key words, then rewrite the email. The maximum length is 60 words, including the subject line.**

Subject: Thank you for your help at the conference in Paris

Thank you so much for all your help during the conference on the future of the airline industry that I attended in Paris last week. Your help was really appreciated as I had never been to France before and everything was very new to me. The conference was really interesting. Of course, while I was there I also had the great pleasure to meet your French sales team. They are a wonderful group of people and I would like you to give my best regards to all of them. As you know, there are plans to bring some of the French staff over here to Dubai at the end of the year to see how we run the Dubai office. I look forward to seeing you then.

Subject: .....

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Note: it is fine to send a very brief, direct email in certain contexts. For example, writing to a colleague you see every day about a routine matter, or writing an email on a smartphone. In some other contexts a very brief, direct email might be seen as rude and unfriendly or might not be clear.

15 Being informal and friendly

A **In informal writing you find many little words and phrases like those below. Add a word from the box to each line of the table.**

Apparently	At the end of the day	If you ask me	In fact	Luckily	Of course	So	~~So~~

You heard something, but are not sure:	*It seems that*	1	
Surprising but true:	*Actually*	2	
Obvious or already known:	*Obviously*	3	
Bad/good fortune:	*Unfortunately*	4	
What you really think:	*To be honest*	5	
Most important thing about a situation:	*Basically*	6	
Changing the subject, or returning to it:	*Anyway*	7	*So*
Preparing to close:	*Anyway*	8	

B **Complete the email with words or phrases from section A. Several answers may be possible, but there is one solution that uses *all eight lines* from the table above.**

Hi, I'm just back from India – I had a fantastic time. (1) ..... , it's one of the best holidays I've ever had. Did you get the photos I sent from my iPhone while I was there? I saw the Taj Mahal! Amazing! (2) ..... , I only had to wait in line 30 mins – some of my friends had to wait hours. I did loads of other great stuff. I went to Jaipur – incredible forts and monuments – and I bought a duvet cover with little mirrors from a craft market. (3) ..... , it was incredibly hot as it was June, but I like the heat!

By the way, have you heard the news? I was talking to Sara and (4) ..... Ekaterina has met a guy she really likes. They're getting married next year! Sara says she met him at a party but he didn't seem very friendly. (5) ..... , I always thought Ekaterina rushed into relationships too quickly, but (6) ..... it's her decision.

(7) ..... , what about you? How's the new job? You haven't been active on Facebook recently so I don't know what you're doing!

(8) ..... , that's all for now. Hope to hear from you soon. Bye!

Note: the email makes sense without the words in the gaps but they help in various ways.

- They bring the email to life and make it more interesting.
- They build the relationship by showing something about the writer's feelings and mood.
- They signal how the writer is going to continue, and so make the email easier to follow.

These words are called 'comment adverbs' in grammar. There are many other examples, like *By the way*, *In particular*, *Ironically*, *Naturally*, *Predictably*, *Surprisingly*, *Unbelievably*, etc.

C **Read aloud the email below twice. First, read it exactly as it is. Then read it again but miss out all the underlined words. What is the difference?**

Hi Patti! Thanks for your email. Your new job sounds really great. I know that you've wanted to work as a graphic designer for ages and ages, and now it's finally happened! Congratulations! I'm sure you'll do really well in the job.
So, what about my news? I arrived in Prague about a month ago. It was quite difficult at first. Of course I couldn't speak the language, and finding a place to live wasn't easy. Then my friend Helena and I found a lovely little flat in the old part of town. It's quite small, but it's full of character and we love it. I'm working as a waitress in a bar where loads of students go. It's okay – I don't suppose I'll do it for long, but it's a way to earn some money.
Anyway, that's all for now. I hope you're well, and give my regards to your family – especially your mother. She was so kind to me when I came and stayed at your house.
All the best,
Vera.

Note: the email is still quite friendly without these extra words, but adding them in helps to build the relationship. They give more detail and more interest. They show the writer's feelings and personality. Informal emails are full of these 'extra' words.

Now rewrite the email below using words and phrases in the box, in the correct places.

[1] Hi Stefan, just to let you know that I can't join you next weekend. I've already arranged to go to Paris. I'm staying with Bernard in his flat, and I need a break.
[2] I've broken up with Rosanna. We've been having a lot of arguments recently and she is going to move to Hamburg. It's a pity.
[3] Then, my job. I have a lot of responsibilities in the office and it's quite stressful. We have customers who call and I never get a break.
[4] I'm sorry if I sound depressed.
Hope to see you soon.
Wilhelm.

Paragraph 1	I'm really sorry but / ~~a few lines~~ / to be honest
Paragraph 2	she told me last month that / Things have been difficult for me recently. First, / , but I think it's best for both of us. / , as you probably know
Paragraph 3	hundreds of / all day long / , the next thing is / Oh well, that's life!
Paragraph 4	, but writing to you has helped. / Anyway, that's all for now. / a bit

Hi Stefan, just a few lines to let you know that

Use a blank sheet of paper.

16 Being polite and diplomatic

Note: the language in this unit is more common in British English than American English.

A The phrases on the left in the table below use neutral language. Complete the table with the more polite/diplomatic phrases from the box.

~~Would you mind~~	I wonder if I could	I was wondering if you could	Perhaps we should
Would you like me to	Why don't we	Would it help if I	Would it be a problem for you if I

Requests (asking somebody else)

Can you … ? 1 Would you mind ..... / ..... ?

Permission (asking something for yourself)

Could I … ? 2 ..... / ..... ?

Offering help

Can I … ? 3 ..... / ..... ?

Suggestions

Shall we … ? 4 ..... / ..... ?

B Here are more ways to make your language polite/diplomatic. Complete the words in each sentence with the missing letters.

There will be a delay. ⇨ 1 I'm sorry, but it l*oo*ks li__ there will be a sm___ delay.

There is a problem. ⇨ 2 There s__ms to be an issue with this. It's no__ing seri___.

I disagree. ⇨ 3 To be hon___, I think it m___t be better to … (+ alternative).

I disagree. ⇨ 4 Yes, I ca_s__ what you're saying, but d__'_ you think that … ?

That gives us very little time. ⇨ 5 Act_____, that does '_ give us mu__ time.

I think it's better to ask Liyu. ⇨ 6 Wou___'_ it be better to ask Liyu?

Quality will be a problem. ⇨ 7 Wh__ ab___ quality? Can we be sure it will be okay?

It will be very expensive. ⇨ 8 It mi___ be qu___ expensive. / It wo_'_ be ch___.

C Rewrite each sentence using the words in brackets to make them more polite/diplomatic.

1 Can we meet again next week? (wonder/could) .....

2 You've made a mistake on the invoice. (there/seems) .....

3 The quality is low. (not very) .....

4 Shall I speak to Mr Baker? (would you like) .....

5 Your estimate for the cost is low. (might/a little) .....

6 We should wait. (wouldn't/better idea) .....

7 It's a bad idea. (honest/I'm not sure/good) .....

8 Let's cancel the project. (perhaps/should think about) .....

D Your boss Chris sends an email to everyone in your department:

I've had several requests for more regular team meetings. I suggest that we have a meeting every Monday morning at 8am to share information and plan the week's work. What do you think?

Complete the words in these possible replies:

1 I can see what you're sa..... Chris, but wh..... a..... the traffic on Monday mornings?
2 Chris – wo.....' ..... some people find 8am a li..... early?
3 To be ho..... Chris, I'm not s..... that would be conv..... for everybody. It's very early.
4 I know what you m..... Chris, but I can see one or two problems with an 8am start.
5 It's a good idea Chris, but d.....' ..... you think that 9am wo..... be b.....r?

Now look back at sentences (1–5) and find:

a) three examples of *Yes, but* ... ./...../.....
b) a short introductory phrase (such as *Actually,*) to prepare the reader for disagreement .....
c) two negative questions to show doubt ...../.....
d) a normal question to show doubt .....

E Make the emails more polite/diplomatic by changing the phrases in *italics*. Use techniques from sections A–D. There may be several possible answers.

Leyla, thanks for your email with the quote from the printers about the new brochure. (1)*It is* (2)*very* expensive. (3)*Isn't it* a better idea to contact some other printing firms and get some alternative quotes? After all, (4)*we have been very unhappy* with the quality of their work on the last few jobs.

1 *It seems to be*
2 .....
3 .....
4 .....

Rashid – sorry we didn't have a chance to talk yesterday. (5)*Shall we* reschedule for next week? Actually, there is something else I was going to mention. (6)*Can you* have a word with Sandra about the new Area Manager job? I'd like to know when it is going to be advertised. (7)*It's delicate* for me because there's a chance that I (8)*will* be one of the candidates.

5 .....
6 .....
7 .....
8 .....

Gabriel, thanks for the suggestions on how to price our new range of accessories. To be honest, (9)*it's a bad idea*. The prices you suggest (10)*are too* high for this market. (11)*Can't you see* that a lower price (12)*will* be better? We don't want to be out of line with the competition.

9 .....
10 .....
11 .....
12 .....

17 Information

A **Complete the 'first contact' email sequence below by writing *one* word in each gap. Some letters have been given to help you.**

I was just reading a blog post on the internet. I saw a reference to the seminar in Krakow on 'Social Media and Marketing' that is being organized by you. (1)Pl_____ se_____ me some details. Also, (2)wou_____ it be po_____ for you to give me a list of hotels near the venue? Thank you in (3)adv_____ for your h_____, and I look forward to hearing from you soon.
Naomi Chandler

Thank you for your email about our seminar in Krakow. You will find (4)fu_____ det_____ in the attached pdf document. Alternatively, you can visit our website at www.euroconference.com where you can also make an online booking.
If you (5)n_____ any more information, please don't (6)he_____ to contact me.
Kind regards
Magda Wojcik
Events Manager

B **Complete the email sequence below by writing *one* word in each gap as before. The emails here are internal ones between colleagues.**

Hi Helena
Just (1)foll_____ u_____ that chat we had the other day where I mentioned EHG. The plan is now that I fly out to Paris next Tuesday to meet the people there.
I'd like to know a (2)li_____ mo_____ about EHG before I go, and you seem like the best person to ask. In (3)pa_____, can you tell me something about Henri Roland, their sales director? Have you met him?
Thanks for this.
Dmitri

No probs, Dmitri. EHG are quite a big operation I've (4)att_____ a Word doc with some (5)back_____ stuff. I've met Henri several times and I think he's someone we can work with. (6)Ge_____ ba_____ to me if you need any more information.
Helena

C Complete the table by matching the phrases in the box with those below.

~~I'd like to know a little more about …~~	Thanks for your help.
Thanks for the email – info you want is attached.	I'm writing about …
Just let me know if you have any questions.	Please send me …
Speak to you soon.	(Mrs Tanaka Yui) gave me your name.

Reason for writing

I am writing in connection with … 1 .....

Your name was given to me by (Mrs Tanaka Yui) 2 .....

Asking for information

I would be grateful if you could send me … 3 .....

Could you give me some information about …? 4 *I'd like to know a little more about …*

Final comments

Thank you in advance for your assistance. 5 .....

If you need any more information, please do not hesitate to contact me. 6 .....

Closing

I look forward to hearing from you soon. 7 .....

Reply: giving information

With reference to your email of 4 May, I have attached the information you asked for. 8 .....

D In general, are the phrases on the *left* in section C more formal or more informal?

E Complete the email below with phrases from the *left* in section C.

I am writing in connection with your market research services for China and East Asia.

(1) ..... Mei Cheung from the Beijing office of B2B Connections – I believe you know her.

We are a medium-sized German company that exports specialized machine tools for the auto industry.

I attach a pdf that gives some background information about our company.

(2) ..... details of the services you provide, including a list of recent clients. We are looking for a market research company with deep knowledge of the auto industry to help us plan our entry into the Chinese market.

(3) ..... . My full contact details including my direct line are given below.

I look forward to hearing from you soon.

Klaus Schafer

18 Action

A Match the beginnings of sentences (1–12) with the endings (a–l).

Asking for action	1 Will you check to ...c...	a) can handle …
	2 I have a couple	b) a favour and find out?
	3 Can you do me	c) see if …?
	4 I know you're busy, but I'd	d) really appreciate your help.
	5 I will take care of … if you	e) willing to …?
	6 Would you be	f) of questions.
Taking action	7 Of course, I'm	g) get back to you asap.
	8 Of course, I'll do it	h) pleased to help.
	9 Let me look into this and I'll	i) me know what you think.
	10 Leave it with me. I'll sort	j) right away.
	11 Below are my suggestions. Let	k) there's anything else I can do.
	12 Let me know if	l) it out and get back to you.

B Memory game. Cover section A with a piece of paper. Complete the email exchanges by filling in the missing words.

Email exchange 1

Bob – the management team are meeting on 14 Feb and they're going to discuss last year's figures. Would you be (1)wi..... to prepare a short report to circulate to everyone beforehand? I know you're busy, but I'd really (2)app..... your help.
Thanks, Lara

> Of course, Lara. No problem. I'll start the report (3)ri..... aw..... . Let me know if there's (4)any..... e..... I can do.

Email exchange 2

Yasemin – we've been asked to help out next Wednesday afternoon. There is a VIP group from Korea coming to visit us. I will (5)ta..... ca..... of meeting them at the airport, if you can (6)ha..... the arrangements for the tour of the plant. Also, will you (7)ch..... to see if Arda and Ben are free for an hour or so to meet them?
Thanks, Isabella.

> Of course Isabella, (8)le..... it with me. I'll (9)so..... o..... the tour, make arrangements for refreshments afterwards, and make sure that either Arda or Ben are free to talk to them. I'll (10)g..... ba..... to you if there are any problems, but I'm sure it will all be fine.
Y.

C **Informal emails between colleagues (like those above) often use phrasal verbs like *get back to* and *sort out*. Match the phrasal verbs below with their meanings.**

1 get back to	a) prepare and write a document or plan
2 find out	b) write or speak to someone at a later time
3 draw up	c) understand, in order to solve a problem (= work out)
4 figure out	d) take action, in order to solve a problem (= deal with)
5 look into	e) discover a piece of information (= discover)
6 sort out	f) try to discover the facts (= investigate)

D **Rewrite the formal sentences *in italics* using phrasal verbs from the list above. All six phrasal verbs are used.**

1 *Please try to discover what is happening, understand why there is a problem and what the solution might be, and then write a report showing the next steps that we should take.*

Please *find* *out* what's going on, ... what to do, and then ..... some kind of action plan.

2 *Don't worry, I'll investigate the situation, I'll do what is necessary to deal with it, and I'll contact you again to say what has happened.*

Don't worry, I'll ..... it, I'll ..... it ....., and I'll ..... you.

E **An action email may be written for a wide audience on a more general issue, like the one below. Cross out the *one* word/phrase in each group in italics that is *not* possible.**

Dear all

Following the meeting last Tuesday about our departmental structure, I have (1)*a proposal/a suggestion/* ~~*an advice*~~ that I am sure will benefit the whole company. It is the following: to merge sales and marketing into one department, and consolidate the operations into our Hong Kong office. It will mean some layoffs in other offices, but of all the (2)*options/milestones/alternatives*, this one is the most cost-effective and (3)*carries/involves/puts* the least risk.

This proposal will (4)*address/explain/solve* several related problems that we have. In particular, issues of coordination between offices, coordination between sales and marketing, and overstaffing in a difficult economic climate.

We have to establish a time schedule for the different steps involved in the merger of the two departments, and set a clear (5)*deadline/time limit/scope* for the end of the process. Of course there will be (6)*liabilities/disagreements/objections*, but I am sure that this proposal will work (7)*as long as/provided that/although* everyone is aware of the need for change.

Given the alternatives discussed at the meeting, the cost is (8)*acceptable/interesting/reasonable* and it will save us money in the (9)*long time/long term/long run*. I have included some detailed figures in the attached document.

Please (10)*say me/tell me/let me know* what you think of this idea.

19 Memos and short messages

A Compare these two emails. How are they different? Which do you think is better?

Version 1

Subject: To all department heads – VIP visitor tomorrow

Tomorrow we will have the pleasure of welcoming Mr Bianchi from Ferrara Textiles as a visitor to our company. His company intends to place a large order with us, and we hope that this will become a long-term business relationship.

It is therefore very important to make a good impression, and all the staff in your department should know about his visit and be as helpful as possible. They should greet him by name, answer any questions he asks, explain procedures, etc.

Mr Bianchi will be looking around the company from about 11.30, after his meeting with me. I would like to make sure that there is someone present in every section over the lunch period, in case the company tour runs late. Thank you for your cooperation in this matter.

Version 2

Subject: To all department heads – VIP visitor tomorrow

Mr Bianchi of Ferrara Textiles will be looking around the company tomorrow, from about 11.30. It is important to make a good impression. Please:

1 Inform all staff in your department.
2 Remind them to greet Mr Bianchi by name and take time to answer his questions.
3 Arrange lunch breaks so that there is always someone available in your section.

Thank you for your cooperation.

Note: for most people, version 1 would take too long to write and read in a busy working day. Version 2 is easy to understand, and it has a clear structure with numbered action points. Short internal notes can be called 'memos'.

Note the following points about internal memos and messages:

- Individual action points (or information points) are organized by numbers, or by headings, or by bullet points.
- The language is neutral, clear and direct.
- Sentences are short and have a simple structure.
- If the message refers to action, imperative verb forms are common (*Inform …, Prepare …*).
- Useful endings: *Thank you for your cooperation. / Please contact me if there are any problems.*

B A typical structure for *any* piece of written communication, short message or longer report, is:

1 Situation 2 Problem or objective 3 Solution or strategy 4 Closing comment

Identify the four stages in section A, version 2 above.

C **Rewrite the email as a short memo. The maximum length is 80 words, including the subject line. Think carefully about what information you need to include.**

Subject: Training course in how to use spreadsheets

I have found some interesting information about a computer training course taking place in the city centre. In our department we use Excel a lot, but we don't really get the maximum benefit from it in terms of cost and time savings. Therefore I think it would be useful for someone from our department to attend this course.

I have a copy of the leaflet advertising the course, and the details are as follows. The name of the course is 'Spreadsheets for Financial Planning', and the course dates are from 4 June to 8 June. The course runs every evening, from 18.00 to 19.30. The cost is □750.

I am available at that time and I would like to go. I can bring back the skills I learn and help other people in the future. I know it's quite expensive, but I would like to ask you if it is possible for the company to pay the course fees. Unfortunately I can't afford to pay for it out of my own money. Thank you very much.

Subject: .....

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D **Rewrite the email to make it simpler and clearer. The maximum length is 80 words, including the subject line. Think carefully about what information you need to include.**

Subject: Mrs Alonso's retirement at the end of the year

As you may know, Mrs Alonso will be retiring at the end of the year. She has made a great contribution to our company, and will be missed by all her colleagues. She has been with the company for 20 years, moving up from Accounts Clerk to Financial Controller during that time.

To show our appreciation, we would like to organize a small leaving party for Mrs Alonso, after work on her final day. We will also present her with a small gift. I have asked Claudia to organize the collection for the gift, and she will be coming round with a large brown envelope if you want to make a contribution – the amount you give is entirely your choice.

The leaving party will be after work on 20 December, in the main conference room. Everyone is welcome, and we hope that as many people as possible will come to say goodbye to Mrs Alonso. I look forward to seeing you there.

Subject: .....

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20 Arranging a meeting

A

Cross out the *one* word or phrase in each group in italics that is *not* correct. The symbol '—' means no word.

1 What time would *be convenient for/be convenient/suit* you?
2 Are you free *sometime/anytime/one time* next week?
3 Could we meet *on/—/at* Thursday *during/on/in* the afternoon? Perhaps *on/—/at* 3pm?
4 Yes, I think I *can/should/would* be able to make next Friday morning.
5 I'll *come back to you/return to you/get back to you* later today to confirm it.
6 I'm out of the office *for/until/till* 2pm. Any time after that *could be/is/would be* fine.
7 I'm sorry but I'm *busy/occupied/tied up* all day next Tuesday. I *am sorry for/regret for/apologize for* any inconvenience caused.
8 *I'm sorry but/I'm afraid but/I'm afraid* I can't *make/control/manage* it on that day.
9 Sorry, I already have *an arrangement/an appointment/a promise* on that day.
10 *What if/What about/How about* Wednesday *instead/in place/as an alternative*?
11 The meeting is urgent. We need to *move it up/bring it forward/take it ahead* to this week.
12 I'm going to be away for a while. Would you *mind/matter/object* if we pushed the meeting back to the following week?
13 I look forward to *see/seeing/speaking* to you next week.
14 Give me a *call/telephone/ring* if you have any problems.
15 Give my *regards/best wishes/compliments* to Lucia.

B

Complete the sequence of emails by writing *one* word in each gap. Several answers may be possible.

Günter – we need to meet to discuss the budget for next year. Could we meet (1) ..... Friday (2) ..... the morning? Let me know if that (3) ..... be good for you. I hope everyone in the Berlin office is well. Give my (4) ..... to Kristina and Alex.
Best wishes, Akiko.

Akiko, I'm (5) ..... but I can't (6) ..... it next Friday I'm (7) ..... all day. (8) ..... about Monday 12 May (9) ..... ? I should be (10) ..... to make a morning meeting, otherwise any time after 4pm (11) ..... be fine.
Hope that's okay, Günter.

Hi Günter. Yes – Monday morning is good for me too. Shall we say 9.30? I look forward to (12) ..... you then. Give me a (13) ..... if you have (14) ..... problems.
Akiko.

C Match the beginnings and endings of the phrases below.

1 Are we still okay ...b...
2 Can we reschedule for .....
3 I'll circulate .....
4 I need to .....
5 Let me know if you .....
6 Something urgent .....

a) finalize arrangements today.
b) for Thursday?
c) has come up.
d) the agenda in the next few days.
e) the following week?
f) want to make any changes.

D Put the complete phrases from section C into the emails below. You may need to change the first letter to lower case.

Hello Charles-Henri. (1) .....? Please get back to me this morning if possible to confirm, as (2) .....
Thanks, Natalia.

Natalia, I'm sorry to ask this at such short notice, but (3) .....?
Perhaps Wednesday 24th? I do apologize, but (4) .....I hope it won't inconvenience you too much.
Best wishes, Charles-Henri.

Okay, fine. Let's make it Wednesday 24th. (5) .....
Please (6) ..... to what we discussed.
Natalia.

E Review the use of *will* (*You will do ...*) and the present continuous (*You are doing ...*) to talk about a future trip.

- *will* is a general future tense.
- The present continuous is used for arrangements and plans; there is a known time and place (although it may not be mentioned), and the arrangement is often personally scheduled.

Complete the email from a secretary by putting the verbs in brackets into a form of *will* or the present continuous. In most cases both forms are possible, but one is more natural.

As you know, you (1) *'re going* (go) to Brussels next Wednesday. You (2) ..... (catch) the 8.00 flight from City Airport. Someone (3) ..... (be) at Brussels airport to take you to the hotel – you (4) ..... (stay) at the Marriot.
At 11.00 you (5) ..... (meet) Mr Cuvier at his office. I'm sure he (6) ..... (take) you out to lunch. After lunch you (7) ..... (not/do) anything until your meeting at 3.30 with the people from the law firm, so you (8) ..... (have) time to go back to the hotel to freshen up.
When Mr Cuvier's secretary sends me the pre-meeting documents, I (9) ..... (forward) them to you.

21 Negotiating with external partners

A Test your use of modal verbs. Underline the correct word.

1 *Can/Shall* you give me some information about your services for corporate clients?
2 I *will/would* be grateful if you *should/could* give me some information about your company.
3 Do you think you *would/could* send me more details?
4 We *must to/need to* discuss this internally before I can go ahead with more planning.
5 How do you think we *should/shall* deal with this?
6 I *will/would* appreciate your advice.
7 We *would/should* be prepared to give you a discount if you paid 50% in advance.
8 That *can/could* be possible.
9 That *shall/should* be possible.
10 I'm not sure. That *might/would* be possible – I need to ask my line manager.
11 Yes, I think that *shall/would* be possible.
12 I think we *need/need to* look again at the timescale and see if it is realistic.
13 Let me know what time *should/would* suit you best.
14 I'm sorry that we *couldn't/wouldn't* use your services this time.

B These phrases are for setting up a project with an external partner. Complete the table by writing each phrase (a–j) on the correct line. Look carefully at the headings in bold.

a) Okay, I'm happy with that for now.
b) I can see your point about … , but …
c) Can you tell me your rates for this kind of work?
d) What do you think is the best way forward?
e) I'm sorry that we couldn't use your services this time, but I hope there will be another opportunity.
f) Would you be able to …?
g) I am willing to … (if you …)
h) What about if we …?
i) The main thing for me is …
j) Let's talk next week.

1	**Asking for information**	What are your usual charges for a job like this? / ..c...
2	**Requests**	Do you think you could …? / .....
3	**Emphasizing a point**	My main concern at this stage is … / .....
4	**Asking for a suggestion**	How do you think we should deal with this? / .....
5	**Making a suggestion**	Why don't we …? / .....
6	**Negotiating: being firm**	I understand what you're saying about … , but … / .....
7	**Negotiating: being flexible**	I would be prepared to … (if you …) / .....
8	**Negotiating: agreeing**	That's fine. Let's go ahead on that basis. / .....
9	**Next steps**	I'll be in touch soon. / .....
10	**Closing**	I look forward to working with you. / .....

C Complete the sequence of emails by using phrases from the lower part of section B. Note: *not* the phrases in the box.

Dear Ms Dupuis
Your name was given to me by Dominique Clement at Toulouse Aeronautical Services. I understand you recently did some training for them on a freelance basis. We need some training along similar lines for our staff: a ten-session course with two hours per session. I am in the process of looking at different options.
I would be grateful if you could give me the following information:

- (1) *What are your usual charges for a job like this?*
- Are you available in early September?
- Some of our employees have requested an online element to the course, so that they can do some of the training at their desks. (2) .....
  Your input would be valuable here.

I look forward to hearing from you soon.
Regards, Tariq Massi

Dear Tariq, thank you for your email.
I attach a pdf file with my current rates and a list of recent clients.
Early September looks fine at the moment. Can you let me know dates, times, number of participants, etc?
In relation to your final point, (3) .....
have an online review for every face-to-face session? I can set up this eLearning for an additional fee, you would host it on your own intranet, and you can of course reuse it for future courses.
Best wishes, Cristine Dupuis

Cristine, Thanks for the quick reply.
(4) ..... the cost, particularly for the eLearning component. We need to discuss this before we go any further as I want to be sure we will get good value for money. (5) ..... send me a sample eLearning package you have already developed, along with its cost to the client?
In your email you asked about dates, numbers, etc. I don't have that information just yet, but I'm getting it together right now and (6) .....

Tariq, below you'll see a link to a short eLearning course that I developed for a client in the hospitality sector. This online material reviews each session of a ten-session training program. The cost to the client for this online component was £7000, and the client has reused it many times with other employees.
(7) ..... develop something similar for you for £6,000, if you paid half the amount in advance to help with my development costs.
(8) ..... value for money, but our training programs are competitively priced and I am sure you will see an immediate benefit in higher productivity.

Cristine, (9) ..... I think we now need to have a face-to-face meeting to discuss the details. How about one afternoon next week?
(10) .....
Best wishes
Tariq

22 Commercial: customer/supplier sequence

A Match words (1–6) with definitions (a–f).

1 a complaint	a) a request by a customer for a company to supply products
2 an invoice	b) a document you get from someone showing you have given them money
3 a quotation/quote	c) a question you ask in order to get information
4 an inquiry	d) a document showing products you bought and must pay for (= a bill)
5 a receipt	e) something you say or write when you are not satisfied or not happy
6 an order	f) the price someone says they will charge you for doing a piece of work

From the list above (1–6) find:

i) three documents sent by the customer to the supplier ...../...../.....

ii) three documents sent by the supplier to the customer ...../...../.....

B Complete this typical customer/supplier sequence with words from the box.

a complaint	information	~~an inquiry~~	an invoice (with the goods)		
the issue	an order	a payment	a quotation	the quotation	a receipt

The customer ...		The supplier ...	
1	makes *an inquiry*	2	sends
3	requests	4	gives
5	makes	6	sends
7	makes	8	sends
9	makes	10	solves

C Below you will see eight emails between a supplier of ornamental plants and a hotel manager. Put them into the correct order. Section B will help you.

a)

Thank you for your email received today. We supply and maintain large, ornamental plants for hotel lobbies and company reception areas. We have been in business for more than ten years and have some of the city's biggest hotels among our clients. Please see the attached document for more details of our products and prices. If you need any more information, please let me know.

b)

I saw your advertisement in a recent copy of Hotel and Catering Monthly. I am interested in your Plant Solutions service for hotel lobbies. Please send more details.

c)

Your visit to our hotel last Tuesday was very useful, and I now have the agreement of my line manager to go ahead with the contract. I am attaching our order as a pdf. Please acknowledge receipt of this email and give us a delivery date.

d)

Further to your last email, I am happy to provide you with the information you need:

- On an order for just 12 plants we could not give any discount. We believe our prices are very competitive and offer excellent value for money.
- Our terms of payment are 30 days from date of invoice.
- Yes, it would be useful to come to the site. Is next Tuesday morning at 10am convenient for you? I can use the opportunity to clarify any other questions that you might have.

e)

I am writing about a visit by one of your maintenance staff earlier today. He left a lot of water on the carpets where he had watered the plants. This was not the high standard of service that we have come to expect from you in the past.

f)

Thanks for your prompt reply. I am interested in obtaining four large plants for our lobby (variety 'Grandifolia') and a further eight for the restaurant area (variety 'Graciosa'). Would you give a discount on an order of this size? Also, can you state your terms of payment as I could not find these on the document you attached? One final thing – do you need to come to the site to see if there is sufficient light? Our address is below.

g)

We are very sorry to hear that the service you received from our company was not up to the usual standard. Unfortunately, a lot of our regular maintenance staff have been ill recently and we had to employ temporary workers. We appreciate the time you have taken to bring this matter to our attention, and as we value our good customer relations we are happy to give you one week's free maintenance. We will also pay any carpet cleaning bill relating specifically to this issue (please forward the bill to me). I apologize again for any inconvenience caused.

h)

We attach an invoice for the supply of 12 ornamental plants to your hotel last week. We would like to remind you that our terms are 30 days. Thank you.

Email order: 1 *b* 2 ..... 3 ..... 4 ..... 5 ..... 6 ..... (later …) 7 ..... 8 .....

D Find a word (or phrase) from the emails above which mean:

1 (email a) to provide people with something that they need. *supply*
2 (email b) words or pictures that try to persuade people to buy a product. .....
3 (email c) to tell someone in writing that you have received something. .....
4 (email d) a good relationship between quality (or quantity) and price. .....
5 (email e) a level of quality, especially one that people consider acceptable. .....
6 (email f) the conditions of a business or legal agreement. .....
7 (email g) to tell someone you are sorry for doing something wrong. .....
8 (email h) to make someone remember something that they must do. .....

23 Commercial: inquiries and orders

A

Look at the paragraph structure below for two emails: an inquiry (request for information) and the reply. Then write the correct paragraph reference next to each sentence below.

Inquiry

1 How you got the contact.
2 Background: your company, your needs, why you are writing.
3 General request for information.
4 Other specific/unusual questions.
5 Close, perhaps including a reference to future business.

Reply

1 Thanks, referring to the date.
2 Say what you are attaching.
3 Highlight one or two key points.
4 Answer any specific questions.
5 Close, saying you are ready to answer any further questions.

a) We are a distributor of kitchen products in Indonesia. We are interested in … *Inquiry 2*
b) I am attaching our current catalogue and price list as a pdf. .....
c) I look forward to an early reply. I am sure that there is a market for your products here in Indonesia. .....
d) Could you also provide details of your shipping times, and whether there is any minimum order. .....
e) Thank you for your email of 4 June inquiring about our products. .....
f) You will note that our line of MagicMix food processors is on special offer. .....
g) Please send us information about your product range, including a price list. .....
h) We met last Thursday on your stand at the Kitchen and Bath Expo. .....
i) If you need any further information, please do not hesitate to contact me. .....
j) We ship the goods within 24 hours of a firm order, and our minimum order is €5,000 for first-time customers. .....

B

Put paragraphs (a–e) in the two emails into the correct order. Section A will help you.

a) We are a Turkish company exporting to the EU, and need a firm of lawyers in France to represent us on some legal matters.
b) In particular, we would like to know your experience in dealing with disputes between companies involved in import/export.
c) I am emailing you via your website, which I found through a Google search.
d) An early reply would be greatly appreciated.
e) I would be grateful for some information about the legal services that your firm offers.

Paragraph order: 1 *c* 2 ..... 3 ..... 4 ..... 5 .....

a) We feel sure that we will be able to represent your interests here in France. May I suggest that I call you at your convenience to discuss the matter further? Please let me know when would be a good time. I look forward to hearing from you soon.
b) Thank you for your email of 4 December asking for information about our legal services.
c) You will also note that we have represented several Turkish companies, including one of Turkey's major textile exporters. Naturally, our experience in this field includes resolving contractual disputes.
d) You will see that the pdf includes a list of our recent clients, and that the list includes many well-known company names.
e) I am attaching a pdf that gives full details of the services we offer.

Paragraph order: 1 ..... 2 ..... 3 ..... 4 ..... 5 .....

C **Complete sentences 1–12 with the pairs of words in the box. Check the meaning of any unknown words in a dictionary.**

amend/accordingly	apologize/inconvenience	assure/attention	~~attached/delay~~
discount/repeat	first-time/pre-payment	goods/firm	grateful/references
processed/track	quotation/credit	records/outstanding	stock/supplies

1 Please complete, sign and return the ...attached... form asap so that your order can be processed without any ...delay....
2 We would be ..... if you could supply the usual bank .....
3 Our normal terms for ..... customers are 50% .....
4 I have spoken to my line manager, and we are pleased to offer a small ..... on this occasion in the hope that it will lead to ..... orders.
5 The ..... will be shipped on receipt of a ..... order. Our normal lead time before shipping is ten working days.
6 We ..... you that your order will have our full ..... and that we will advise you immediately of any out-of-stock items.
7 We accept your ..... and will ask our bank to issue a letter of ..... shortly. Please ship at the first available opportunity.
8 Your order has been ..... You can ..... the shipping progress on our website. Just log in with your customer details and look at the My Orders section.
9 We note from our ..... that payment of invoice 5718 is still .....
10 This item is temporarily out of ....., but we expect new ..... shortly.
11 Thank you for bringing this matter to our attention. We ..... again for any ..... which may have been caused.
12 There is a mistake in the invoice. The correct information is given below. Please ..... your records ..... and resend a new invoice.

24 Commercial: discussing terms

A Match words (1–8) with definitions (a–h).

1 discount	a) the legal conditions in a sales contract
2 credit	b) when the item leaves the manufacturer or warehouse (= dispatch)
3 terms	c) the smallest number of items that can be supplied
4 minimum order	d) a reduction in the usual price of something
5 warranty	e) when the item arrives at the premises of the customer
6 procedure	f) the correct or usual way of doing something
7 shipping date	g) an arrangement to buy a product and pay for it later
8 delivery date	h) a written promise to repair or replace a product if it is faulty (= guarantee)

Now match each group of verbs below with one of these nouns: *an agreement, a compromise, an offer, an order*. Check any unknown words in a dictionary.

9 cancel/confirm/make/place/receive .....
10 accept/increase/make/reject/withdraw .....
11 keep to/make/negotiate/reach/sign .....
12 accept/agree on/find/reach/suggest .....

B Complete the emails by writing *one* word in each gap. The first letter(s) have been given.

Email 1

Dear Ms Newman

Thank you for sending the pdf with your current catalogue and price (1) *list*. We are interested in purchasing 5,000 (2) *pie*..... of product ref TG67, and 2,000 of product ref K800. However, there are one or two things we would like to clarify before going ahead with a firm (3) *o*..... :

1 Do you give any (4) *d*..... on an order of this (5) *s*..... ?
2 Would you be (6) *pre*..... to let us have the goods on (7) *cr*..... ? Other suppliers offer us 60 days from the (8) *inv*..... date. We can of course supply the usual bank (9) *ref*..... .
3 We can find no mention of shipping times in your documentation. We need these items by the end of October at the (10) *la*..... .

If we can (11) *re*..... an agreement on these matters, we are sure that we can do more business with you in the future. We are a (12) *w*..... *-kn*..... company that has been in the market for over 20 years.

We look forward to hearing from you soon.

Pavel Witkiewicz

Email 2

Dear Mr Witkiewicz

Thank you for your email of 2 August regarding a possible order for our products ref nos. TG67 and K800. I will go through your questions in order.

1 In (13)*rel*_____ to discounts, we would be happy to let you have a discount of 5% on an order of this size.

2 With (14)*reg*_____ to your request for credit, unfortunately, we are not able to offer 60 days credit to (15)*f*_____-*t*_____ customers. However, I am sure we can find an acceptable (16)*com*_____. In view of your reputation in the market, our (17)*acc*_____ department will agree to 30 days, with no pre-payment necessary. You mention bank references, and yes – our normal (18)*pro*_____ is to check these. So we will be requiring full bank details if you decide to go (19)*ah*_____ with an order.

3 Your final question is about shipping. We can supply the items you require directly from (20)*sto*_____, and the goods will leave our warehouse within two working days of a firm order.

Please also note that we have recently improved the functionality of our website, and it is now possible to (21)*pl*_____ an order online. Alternatively, you can print out the attached order form, (22)*f*_____ it in, sign it, and fax it to us.

I have arranged for a member of our customer services team to (23)*g*_____ you a call later in the week. They will be able to (24)*d*_____ with any further questions.

Thank you for your interest in our products.

Sylvia Newman

C **Underline the correct prepositions in each sentence, without looking at emails 1 and 2 above.**

1 Thank you *for/about* your interest in our products.
2 We are interested *in/to* purchasing 5,000 pieces.
3 Do you give discounts *to/on* an order of this size?
4 We will be happy to deal *to/with* any further questions.
5 Is it possible to buy the goods *on/with* credit?
6 We need these items *until/by* the end of October at the latest.
7 I am sure we can reach an agreement *on/for* this matter.
8 We have 20 items *on/in* order with you. Have they been shipped yet?
9 Thank you for your email about a possible order *by/for* our products.
10 In relation *with/to* discounts, our terms are 5% for an order over €10,000.
11 We offer a discount *of/by* 5%.
12 With regard to your request *for/of* 60 days credit, unfortunately we are not able to do this.
13 There are one or two things to clarify before going *ahead/in front* with an order.
14 Our company has been *on/in* the market for over 40 years.
15 This product has been *on/in* the market for over a year.
16 We are prepared to compromise *at/over* the question of splitting the extra transport costs.
17 We can supply the items you require directly *of/from* stock.
18 The goods will leave our warehouse *within/until* two working days of a firm order.

25 Commercial: asking for payment

A Make complete sentences by using one phrase from each column.

1	I wish to draw	overdue payment	to continue.
2	There is an	be allowed	to my two previous emails.
3	We are concerned that	your attention	received your attention.
4	This situation cannot	the matter has not yet	on your account.
5	We must urge you to take	your cooperation in	to recover the money.
6	We have still not	but to take legal action	the outstanding sum.
7	We shall have no alternative	received payment for	resolving this matter.
8	We would appreciate	immediate action to	settle your account.

Note: *overdue* and *outstanding* = 'not yet paid'; *to settle* = 'to pay all the money you owe'.

B Read the emails below. Which email is the:

first reminder ..... second reminder ..... third reminder ..... final demand .....

Email 1

Following my emails of 12 March, 31 March and 15 April I must inform you that we have still not received payment for the outstanding sum of £4,500. Unless we receive payment within seven days we shall have no alternative but to take legal action to recover the money.

Email 2

According to our records, the sum of £4,500 is still outstanding on your account.
We would appreciate your cooperation in resolving this matter as soon as possible.

Email 3

I wish to draw your attention to my previous emails of 12 March and 31 March about the overdue payment on your account. We are very concerned that the matter has not yet received your attention. Clearly, this situation cannot be allowed to continue, and we urge you to take immediate action to clear your account.

Email 4

On 12 March I wrote to you regarding your company's unpaid invoices. The outstanding amount is £4,500.
We note that this amount has still not been transferred to our bank.
Please settle the account without further delay.

C **The first reminder should be strong, but also polite. Don't assume your customer has no intention of paying. Tick (✓) the most polite form each time, a) or b).**

1 a) This invoice should be paid as soon as possible. .....
  b) You must pay this invoice immediately. .....
2 a) You have not paid invoice JK387. .....
  b) We note from our records that invoice JK387 has not been paid. .....
3 a) The balance on your account is now overdue. .....
  b) You owe us a lot of money. .....
4 a) Please send a bank transfer to clear this amount. .....
  b) Please send a bank transfer to clear this amount. If you have already dealt with this matter, then please disregard this email. .....

D **Complete the emails with phrases in the box.**

~~concerning a payment~~	have still not received	please do not hesitate
shall have no alternative	should have been paid	settle your account
two months overdue	without further delay	

First reminder

We are writing to you (1) *concerning a payment* of £12,600 for invoice number KJ678 which is now overdue. A copy of the invoice is attached. This amount (2) ..... by the end of last month.
Please make a bank transfer to (3) ....., or provide an explanation of why the balance is still outstanding. If you have already dealt with this matter, please disregard this email.

Second reminder

With reference to my email of 8 September, I must inform you that we (4) ..... a payment to clear the balance on your account. I am sure you are aware that late payments create problems for us. We would appreciate payment of the outstanding sum (5) .....
If you have any queries on this matter, (6) ..... to contact me.
Thank you for your cooperation.

Final demand

I wrote to you on 8 September and 31 September regarding the balance of £12,600 on your account. I attach copies of both emails. This sum is now (7) ..... We are very concerned that the matter has not yet received your attention.
Please make an immediate payment by bank transfer within seven days.
If we do not receive payment, we (8) ..... but to take legal action to recover the full amount.

26 Job application

A **Put the parts below into the correct order to make a complete email. The writer is sending an 'email cover letter' that introduces an attached CV/resume. Read it aloud when you finish.**

Note: CV is more common in Europe, *resume* (which is sometimes written *résumé*) is more common in the U.S. Check which term is used by the company advertising the job.

a) hesitate to contact me. You will find my telephone number, email address and

b) To whom it may concern. With reference to your advertisement on the JobFinders website, I am interested in applying for the post

c) and cultural activities over the last few years, as well as dealing

d) my CV as a Word document. You will notice in the CV that I have supervised children on a range of sports

e) for the opportunity to discuss my application further with you, and am available for interview

f) summer vacations I have worked as a youth leader in Turkey, and I enjoyed the work very much. This summer I would like to do something more varied

g) of tour leader for Turkish school students. I am 26 years old and am currently studying

h) Skype name below. I look forward to hearing from you soon. Yours sincerely Evrim Kemal
Tel: +90 (0)473542543 Email: evrim-kemal@yahoo.com Skype: evrim-kemal

i) for a diploma in Tourism at Izmir University. When I finish I hope to follow a career in the travel industry. During the last few

j) a lot of energy and enthusiasm, and I am also responsible and reliable. I have attached

k) young people on trips to London. I think I would be very well suited to this job as I have

l) with administrative matters such as transport arrangements and tickets. You will also see that I have achieved very high grades in spoken English at university. I would be grateful

m) by telephone or Skype any weekday afternoon. Should you require any additional information, please don't

n) and challenging, and for this reason I am applying for the job advertised, leading groups of

1 *b* 2 ..... 3 ..... 4 ..... 5 *n* 6 ..... 7 .....
8 *d* 9 ..... 10 ..... 11 *e* 12 ..... 13 ..... 14 .....

B **The email in section A on the previous page is one long paragraph. Show where new paragraphs could begin by writing a // symbol in the text. The structure below will help you.**

1	**Greeting**	The real name is best if you know it, otherwise *Dear Hiring Manager for* [name of position] or *To whom it may concern*.
2	**Reason for writing**	Where you saw the advertisement; which job you are interested in.
3	**Your background**	Present job and/or studies; your qualifications; recent work experience.
4	**The job itself**	The skills and personal qualities that make you suitable for this job.
5	**Refer to CV/resume**	Ask the reader to look at your CV, and focus on one or two key points.
6	**Final comments**	Express your interest in the next application stage; say when you are available for interview and how you can be contacted.
7	**Standard close**	The most common is *I look forward to hearing from you soon.*
8	**Formal ending**	*Yours truly* (American English) or *Yours sincerely* (British English)

C **Complete each gap with *one* of these words: *as, at, for, from, in, of, on, to.***

1 With reference ..... your advertisement ..... the JobFinders website, I am interested ..... applying ..... the post of tour leader.
2 I have attached my CV ..... a Word document.
3 I am available ..... interview by telephone or Skype.
4 I'm working ..... a sales representative at the moment.
5 You can telephone me ..... the number below.
6 I look forward ..... hearing ..... you soon.
7 I have a good knowledge ..... business administration. I studied it ..... university.
8 I'm studying ..... a degree ..... Business Administration.
9 I hope to follow a career ..... the legal profession.
10 I have been working ..... Telekom since leaving university.
11 I attach my CV ..... requested.
12 I would be grateful ..... the opportunity to discuss my application further with you.

Note these tips for writing an email cover letter:

- Your cover letter should show the employer how you can meet their needs, not how working at their company will fulfil your own career wishes.
- Make a strong connection between the skills and experience asked for in the job advertisement and your own skills and experience.
- Keep your cover letter brief. A guideline is to write four or five main paragraphs, with two or three sentences in each.

27 Complaints

A Complete the sentences typical of complaint emails with the pairs of words in the box.

attention/issue	~~connection/attitude~~	delivered/urgently	entitled/replacement
matter/inconvenience	package/ordered	purchased/standard	quality/purchased
refund/escalate	replace/goods	terms/treatment	unless/cancel

1 I am writing in ...*connection*... with the negative ...*attitude*... of a member of your staff.
2 I hope that you will deal with this ..... promptly as it is causing me considerable .....
3 The equipment I ordered has still not been ....., despite my phone call to you last week to say it is needed .....
4 Although you advertise yourself as a top-quality brand, the product I ..... was well below the ..... I expected.
5 I am writing to draw your ..... to an ..... in your customer services section.
6 Please ..... the faulty ..... as soon as possible.
7 I wish to complain in the strongest possible ..... about the ..... I received from a member of your staff.
8 I believe that I am .....to an immediate .....
9 When we opened the ..... there were only 50 items instead of the 60 we .....
10 ..... I receive the goods by the end of this week, I will have no choice but to ..... my order.
11 I am writing to complain about the ..... of a product I ..... on your website.
12 I insist on a full ....., otherwise I will be forced to ..... the matter by asking our accounts department to contact your head office directly.

B Match the beginnings (1–8) with the endings (a–h).

1 You only sent seven DVDs, instead .....
2 You only sent seven DVDs, in spite of .....
3 Even though I paid for eight DVDs, ...
4 I paid for eight DVDs. .....
5 I paid for eight DVDs, ...
6 First, the quantity of DVDs was incorrect. .....
7 The DVD issue is still not resolved. .....
8 You still haven't dealt with the DVD issue, ...

a) there were only seven in the box.
b) but there were only seven in the box.
c) However, there were only seven in the box.
d) so I'm refusing to pay your invoice.
e) Therefore, we are refusing to pay your invoice.
f) of the eight that I ordered.
g) the fact that I paid for eight.
h) Second, two of the cases were damaged.

C Complete each phrase with *one* word. Some letters have been given to help you.

1 to write in *connection* with sth.
2 to need sth. *ur*.....*y*
3 to *esc*.....*te* the matter
4 to insist on a full *re*.....*d*
5 to replace a *fa*.....*y* item
6 to be below the expected *st*.....*d*
7 to complain in the strongest possible *te*.....*s*
8 to draw sb's *at*.....*ion* to sth.
9 to demand an immediate *repl*.....*nt*
10 to cause sb. considerable *in*.....*ience*

D Linking words and phrases are used in complaints to explain your case clearly and carefully. Complete the table with words/phrases in the box.

Actually	As a result	Even though	Finally	Firstly	~~Furthermore~~
However	In addition	In conclusion	In fact	~~In particular~~	In spite of the fact that
On the other hand	Specifically	Taking everything into consideration			Therefore

Adding another point (like *and*):	1	*Furthermore* /
Adding more exact information:	2	*In particular* /
Listing points:	3	/
Making a contrast (like *but*):	4	/
Making a contrast (like *although*):	5	/
Giving the consequence (like *so*):	6	/
Saying something true but surprising:	7	/
Introducing the final paragraph:	8	/

E <u>Underline</u> the most appropriate words or phrases in the email.

I am writing to complain about the poor service we have received from your company. (1)*Firstly/Therefore*, the goods you sent were not the ones that we ordered. Our order dated 16 September clearly stated that we wanted 1,000 t-shirts. (2)*In particular/However*, we only received 800. (3)*Nevertheless/Furthermore*, we asked you to print our company logo in the top left front corner of the shirts and you have printed it at the back.
To make matters worse, your staff were very unhelpful when I called. (4)*Even though/Specifically*, I was passed from person to person and no-one took responsibility. (5)*In fact/On the other hand*, after 30 minutes I just gave up in frustration and ended the call.
The whole matter was treated by your staff as though it was completely unimportant, (6)*in spite of the fact that/therefore* we have been your customers for more than five years. (7)*In particular/As a result*, we are going to end our business relationship with you.
(8)*In conclusion/In addition*, we must insist on an immediate replacement order, to reach here within ten working days, at no cost to ourselves.

28 Apologies

A **Below you can read a formal apology (email 1), and an informal apology (email 2). Complete the emails by choosing from each pair of phrases.**

1 for / on behalf of
2 unprofessional conduct / unfortunate behaviour
3 Please accept my sincere apologies for / I'm really sorry for
4 You can be sure that / You have my assurance that
5 put things right / resolve the matter to your satisfaction
6 to compensate for the inconvenience caused / to say sorry
7 about what happened / regarding the incident
8 If I can be of further assistance / If there's anything else I can do
9 please call / do not hesitate to contact me

Email 1: formal

I am writing (1) *on behalf of* Tiger Trading Company in relation to your complaint about the promotional t-shirts you ordered and the attitude of our staff when you called.
I was very concerned to learn about the problems you experienced and the (2) ..... of our sales staff. (3) ..... everything that happened, and thank you for bringing it to my attention. (4) ..... I will (5) ..... .
We will send replacement items immediately, at our expense, and I will personally make sure that the order is correct before shipping. We will also send you a credit note to be used against any items in our catalogue (6) ..... .
I have spoken to our staff (7) ..... and we are putting in place measures to make sure that in the future all customer relations are handled in a polite and helpful manner.
Once again, I hope you will accept my sincere apologies.
(8) ..... (9) ..... on my direct line given below.

Email 2: informal

Laura, I'm writing (1) *for* all our family to say thank you so much for letting us stay at your beautiful seaside house at the weekend. We really enjoyed it.
By now you have probably heard from your neighbours about the (2) ..... of my teenage son Harry and his friends when they came back from the pub late on Saturday night.
(3) ..... all the noise they made, and for what they did to your garden. (4) ..... I will do everything possible to (5) ..... .
I'll pay for any damage, of course. I've also sent you some flowers and a box of chocolates (6) ..... . I've already spoken to my son (7) ..... and he is very ashamed and promises it won't happen again.
Once again, I am really sorry. (8) ....., (9) ..... I'll be at home at the weekend.

B Match the beginnings of the sentences (1–10) with the endings (a–j).

1 Please accept my *g*
2 We're having a temporary issue with .....
3 We're doing everything we can to .....
4 Can you leave it with me for a .....
5 I'll look into the matter right now .....
6 Of course, I will send you .....
7 We are sending you a small gift .....
8 I can assure you that this .....
9 I apologize again for any .....
10 If you have any further questions, ...

a) a replacement immediately.
b) and get back to you asap. Speak soon.
c) day or two? I need to see what's going on.
d) inconvenience this has caused.
e) do not hesitate to contact me.
f) sort things out. I'm sure it won't take long.
g) sincere apologies.
h) will not happen again.
i) as a gesture of goodwill.
j) our IT network.

Check the answers, then cover the right hand column and try to remember the endings.

C Cross out the *one* word or phrase in italics that is *not* natural.

1 I am ~~*absolutely*~~/*so*/*really*/*very* sorry for what has happened.
2 Thank you for bringing this *issue*/*material*/*matter*/*problem* to our attention.
3 We can assure you that the *products*/*goods*/*items*/*wares* were shipped on time.
4 We were sorry to hear that the product was *damaged*/*defective*/*faulty*/*out of work* when you received it.
5 This was due to *an oversight when we processed your order*/*a strike in our factory*/*an inflammation in our warehouse*/*circumstances beyond our control.*
6 I am trying to *sort it out*/*sort out it*/*sort the problem out*/*sort out the problem* as a matter of urgency.
7 Please return the faulty goods, and we will *refund you*/*repair them*/*replace them*/*restore them* immediately.
8 We appreciate that this has caused you considerable inconvenience, but we cannot accept any *breach of contract*/*disadvantage*/*liability*/*responsibility* on our part.

D Rewrite the sentences below with the correct word order.

1 Thank you very much this matter for bringing to my attention.
.....
2 I was very experienced to learn the problems about you concerned.
.....
3 I will look the matter into and get back you to within the few next days.
.....
4 Once again, accept our apologies please caused for the inconvenience.
.....
5 Having this matter in detail looked into, I be of no further assistance regret that I can.
.....

29 Reports: structure and key phrases

A Match the different sections of a report (1–5) with their definitions (a–e).

1	Introduction	a)	The 'body' of the report: a presentation of arguments and evidence.
2	Background	b)	The subject of the report, who asked for it, why it has been written.
3	Findings	c)	Practical suggestions for action, often written as a list or bullet points.
4	Conclusion	d)	The context: what has happened up to now and the general situation.
5	Recommendations	e)	A judgment or decision based on the facts and discussion in the 'body'.

Note:

- Reports are all different, and may not have the sections above. Many reports use a standard format that is given by the organization.
- The 'Findings' section will probably have headings and sub-headings that relate to that particular report.
- In theory the recommendations are based on the conclusion, but in practice these two are often combined into a single section. Alternatively, the findings and recommendations may be presented together.
- In an email, the structure 1–5 above may be used in some way, but a 'section' could simply be a single sentence.
- The sections may be in a different order.

B Match the beginnings of the sentences (1–12) with the endings (a–l).

1	Here is my report, as requested ..e..	a)	on figures provided by the different departments.
2	The purpose of the report is	b)	the economic situation, but there are other reasons.
3	The report is based	c)	chart 1 below, sales have been falling steadily.
4	I have divided the report	d)	to review ways to reduce costs across the company.
5	As can be seen in	e)	by the Board at their meeting of 18 April.
6	Our lower sales are partially due to	f)	into three sections.
7	It is clear that we are in a situation	g)	are as follows:
8	I believe it is possible to do this	h)	where it is necessary to cut our costs.
9	My specific recommendations	i)	any time if you have any questions.
10	Please look at the full report, ...	j)	without damaging operational efficiency.
11	These will all be circulated	k)	attached as a pdf, and let me have your comments.
12	Feel free to contact me at	l)	in time for the next meeting, on 24 October.

Sentences 1–12 are already in the order in which they would be used. Write the sentence numbers after these section headings:

Introduction/Background: ..1.., ..2.., ..3.., ..4..

Findings: .....

Conclusion/Recommendations: .....

Closing comments: .....

C Complete the email with the phrases in the box.

as follows	easily achievable	focussed on	how to proceed	let me have your comments
partially due to	Feel free	purpose of this report	smaller budget	summary

Subject: Report on reducing costs

Introduction

Here is my report, as requested by the Board. The (1) _____ is to review ways to reduce costs across the company. The full report is attached as a pdf, and there is a (2) _____ below.

Background

Sales have been falling steadily across all product lines. These lower sales are (3) _____ the economic situation, but there are other reasons:

- Our new products have not generated any excitement amongst consumers.
- Our marketing has been unfocussed.
- Our sales force is poorly motivated.

The CEO is preparing a separate report on the above three issues. My report attached here is (4) _____ measures to reduce costs, which are clearly also necessary.

Findings and recommendations

My specific recommendations, based on the findings detailed in the full report, are (5) _____:

1 Marketing can make reductions in the advertising budget of 10% or 15%.

We are still spending large sums on ineffective magazine and billboard advertising. Our marketing effort needs to be refocused, and will have to move forward with a (6) _____.

2 Production can improve productivity and find alternative suppliers.

Our production costs are too high. We need to improve internal productivity and reduce the cost of our inputs. I believe this is (7) _____.

3 Head Office can identify areas for cutting administrative staff.

We will have to dismiss a small number of back-office staff, which will be very unpopular. The decision as to (8) _____ in this sensitive matter should be made by Head Office.

Conclusion

I believe it is possible to cut costs without damaging operational efficiency.

Please look at the full report, attached as a pdf, and (9) _____ by 14 October at the latest. These will be circulated to all departmental managers in time for the meeting on 24 October.

(10) _____ to contact me at any time if you have any questions.

30 Linking words and relative clauses

A First, read the information about linking words and phrases.

Examples of linking words are: *and*, *but*, *because*, *so*, *However*, *Therefore*, *In general*, etc. These words and phrases join one idea to another. They help the reader to understand the structure of an argument. When linking words come at the beginning of a sentence they are usually followed by a comma.

Now read through the email and underline 14 linking words/phrases. The first one has been done for you. Do not include *and*, *but*, *or* and *so*.

Subject: Arrangements for sales conference

Abdullah – many thanks for sending the details of the 165 participants coming to our sales conference in November. Here is my report on the arrangements that will be necessary.

1 Accommodation

In previous years we have used the Transocean Hotel. In general, we have always had good feedback from delegates about the Transocean. However, its location is not ideal for the conference centre, and in addition they have increased their prices recently. As a result, I am going to get an alternative quote from the Beach View this year.

2 Conference Centre

In relation to numbers, the hall seats 200 people, so there shouldn't be any problems. Nevertheless, if we get a lot of late bookings we may need a bigger hall. I will monitor the situation closely. Obviously, if people book after the deadline we may have to write back to them and say we are full.

On another point, we need to make sure that the amplification system is working properly, as last year several delegates complained that the sound was too low at the back of the hall.

3 Speakers

All four outside speakers are confirmed. In particular, the well-known author Sandra Brett has agreed to give a talk on 'Social media marketing: where next?', and I'm sure it will be very well received.

4 Food and drink

Last year this was a problem. Firstly, we had a lot of complaints about the food. Secondly, there was some confusion among participants about whether they should stay in the conference centre for lunch or go outside. In fact, if people do want to go outside and get some fresh air it is not a problem. So this year I am going to contact some new catering companies that we haven't used before, and I'll ask them to provide a simple cold buffet. Delegates can choose this option on the day. Alternatively, people can make their own arrangements for lunch if they wish, and I'll make it clear that this is possible.

I think that's all. Let me know if there's anything else, especially if you suddenly get a lot of late bookings.

Khushi

B Complete the table with words from the boxes.

Above all	~~Finally~~	Furthermore	In particular	Nevertheless	On another point
On the other hand	On the whole	~~Secondly~~	Typically		

Sequence:	*Firstly*	1	*Secondly* / *Finally*
Talking generally:	*In general*	2	..... / .....
Contrast:	*However*	3	..... / .....
Adding another point:	*In addition*	4	..... / .....
Important example:	*Especially*	5	..... / .....

As far as … is concerned	Actually	As a matter of fact	For this reason	In short	
Obviously	Of course	Therefore	So, to sum up	With reference to	

Surprising but true:	*In fact*	6	..... / .....
Something obvious:	*Clearly*	7	..... / .....
Result/Consequence:	*As a result*	8	..... / .....
New topic:	*In relation to*	9	..... / .....
Summarizing	*In brief*	10	..... / .....

Note also these common phrases that come from Latin: *ie = that is to say / eg = for example*

C Review relative clauses. Note how two sentences can be joined as one.

The Board issued a report. It describes options for our long-term strategy.
⇨ *The report* ***that the Board issued*** *describes options for our long-term strategy.*

The Board issued a report. It describes options for our long-term strategy.
⇨ *The Board issued a report* ***which describes options*** *for our long-term strategy.*

Marketing want to postpone the product launch. I feel this is a mistake.
⇨ *Marketing want to postpone the product launch,* ***which I feel is a mistake.***

Now write each pair of sentences as one sentence, including the word in brackets. Begin as shown, and make any necessary changes.

1 We interviewed three candidates. They were all very good. **(who)**
We interviewed .....

2 We interviewed three candidates. They were all very good. **(that)**
The three .....

3 We need to lay off some workers. They are listed below. **(who)**
The workers .....

4 One sales team had particularly good results. They should be given a bonus. **(whose)**
The sales team .....

5 Our market share is now around 22%. This is 2% more than last year. **(which)**
Our market share .....

31 Describing trends

A Review the language of trends (= how a situation is changing and developing).

1 Complete the pairs of *opposite* verbs with the words in the box.

be down	get worse	be stable	~~go down~~	decrease	hit a low	fall	shrink

a) go up / *go down*
b) rise / .....
c) improve / .....
d) peak / .....
e) increase / .....
f) grow / .....
g) be up / .....
h) be variable / .....

2 Write the nouns for some of the verbs above.

a) to rise / a *rise*
b) to improve / an .....
c) to grow / .....

3 Complete the phrases with: *gradually*, *sharply*, *significantly*, *slightly*, *slowly*, *steadily*.

a) Sales increased *slowly* (not fast)
b) Sales increased ..... (suddenly)
c) Sales increased ..... (a little)
d) Sales increased ..... (noticeably and a lot)
e) Sales increased ..... (slowly over a long time)
f) Sales increased ..... (continuously and unlikely to change)

4 Change the *verb + adverb* form into an *adjective + noun* form.

a) Sales improved gradually. ⇨ There was a *gradual improvement* in sales.
b) Market share grew slowly. ⇨ We saw ..... in our market share.
c) Profits rose slightly. ⇨ We saw a ..... in profits.

5 Complete the sentences with: *at*, *by*, *for*, *from*, *in*, *of*, *since*, *to*.

a) Sales of this line increased ..... 15,000 ..... 17,500. So, they increased ..... 2,500.
b) Last year we had a market share ..... 14%. After the recent increase ..... sales it now stands ..... 18%.
c) Costs have been increasing ..... January (*point in time*) / ..... six months (*period of time*).

B Underline the correct words in the email.

Somchai, here are the main points from the Q2 results:

- At the start of the quarter sales stood (1)*in/at* $25 million. They (2)*rose/rised* over the three month period (3)*to/until* $27.6 million – that's an increase (4)*by/of* around 12%.
- The trend is good, with (5)*steady/steadily* (6)*growing/growth* forecast for the rest of the year.

Congratulations to everyone involved. However, there is a downside. Market share is not growing – in fact it's been more or less stable (7)*for/since* the last few years. So, in a (8)*rapid/rapidly* growing market our competitors have benefited as much as us. We must work on this.

I look forward to hearing your comments.

Regards, Hanif

C **Review the language of forecasts (what is likely to happen in the future). Complete the sentences with the words/phrases in the box.**

I doubt	I expect	I'm sure	might/may	will definitely

1 I'm certain. Sales of this line _____ go up.
2 I can't really say at this stage. Sales of this line _____ go up a little.
3 Sales of this line definitely won't go up. _____ of it.
4 Sales of this line are likely to go up. _____ an increase of around 10% next quarter.
5 Sales of this line probably won't go up much. In fact, _____ they will increase at all.

Now match the beginnings 6–8 with the endings a)–c). Be careful!

6 We expect/think/hope/believe/predict/forecast
7 We expect/hope/intend/plan
8 We expect

a) sales to increase next year.
b) sales will increase next year.
c) to increase sales next year.

Note: we can usually use 'will' or 'going to' for forecasts and there is very little difference between them. However, if there is strong evidence in the present situation then 'going to' is more common. Compare:

I think sales ***will probably increase*** *next year.* (it's my general belief)
I think sales ***are probably going to increase*** *next year.* (I am looking at some figures right now)

D **Underline the correct words/phrases in the email.**

Somchai – thanks for getting back to me so quickly with your comments. Yes, all good points. At the end you ask me for my thoughts about the longer term, so here they are:

- Sales are (1)*possible/likely* to end this year (2)*with/at* about $34m. And, because our cost-cutting measures are working (3)*good/well*, net profits (4)*maybe/might* increase at an even faster rate.
- Next year the situation is a lot more (5)*uncertain/unlikely*. This is because of the general economic climate we are operating in. People are being very careful with their money, and they aren't buying so many new homes. And if a recession develops, then (6)*I doubt/I expect* sales of household appliances like ours will be hit (7)*significant/significantly*.
- Inflation (8)*will probably/probably will* start to rise, and so interest rates will have to go up as well. That's bad news for us because of that money we borrowed from the bank last year. But rates (9)*probably won't/won't probably* go much beyond 5%, so the situation should be manageable.

Anyway, we can discuss all this in more detail at the next sales conference. But the evidence suggests that we (10)**will have/are going to have* a difficult time over the next few years.
Hanif

*For #10 both answers are possible, but one is more natural.

32 Explaining trends

A

Review the language of cause and effect. Complete the sentences with words/phrases in the box. Use a capital letter for the answers to 3.

because of this	lead to	resulted from	result in	therefore	was a result of	was due to

1 The new marketing campaign should *create* / ..... / ..... a lot more hits on our website.
2 The big increase in hits on our website *was because of* / ..... / ..... / ..... the new marketing campaign.
3 Next month will be the start of the new marketing campaign. *So*, / ..... / ....., we should see a big increase in hits on our website.

Note the use of *so/such … that* to express cause:

so + adjective/adverb:	*The marketing campaign was* ***so successful*** *we …*
such a + noun:	*The marketing campaign was* ***such a success*** *that we …*
such a + adjective + noun:	*It was* ***such a successful marketing campaign*** *that we …*

B

Underline the correct words or phrases in the email.

Kulap, sorry it's taken so long to get back to you – it's been (1)*so/such* a busy week. Anyway, I've finally had a chance to look at the sales figures in more detail. Here are my thoughts:

- It's very good news that sales are growing (2)*so/such* fast. The market as a whole is growing, and (3)*as a result/because of* we have benefited along with all our competitors.
- If you look at the figures you'll see that much of the increase is (4)*due to/result from* the success of just two product lines, Viva and Avanti. We had a big advertising campaign for Viva before Christmas, which (5)*resulted to/led to* the peak in sales in December. Avanti on the other hand has been selling well all through the year, probably (6)*because of/because* it already has a good reputation in the market.
- We must make sure that our new lines – to be introduced next month – are equally successful. (7)*Therefore/Despite*, someone needs to prepare a detailed marketing plan in time for the next meeting. Jim should probably deal with this (8)*because of/because* his work on Viva and Avanti. I'll suggest it to him.

Hope this is helpful,
Yang Dongsheng

C Review the language of contrast. Complete the words with the missing letters.

1 Sales increased, **alth**____ market share was unchanged.

2 **Ev**__ **thou**__ market share was unchanged, sales increased.

3 Sales increased, **where**___ / **whi**__ market share was unchanged.

4 Market share was unchanged **in sp**____ **of / des**____ the increase in sales.

5 **In spite of the fa**__ **th**__ sales increased, market share was unchanged.

6 Sales increased. **How**____ / **Nev**_____**ss, / E**__ **n so**, market share was unchanged.

Note:

- *Even though* makes a stronger contrast than *Although*.
- *Although* has a sense of surprise. *Whereas/While* emphasize the difference between two facts, without a sense of surprise.
- *In spite of* is followed by a noun phrase. *In spite of the fact that* is followed by subject + verb.
- *However* and *Nevertheless* are more formal. *Even so* is less formal.

D Read the email. Then choose the best word to fill each gap from A, B, C or D below. Language from Unit 31 is also practised.

Hiroshi – here is the summary of the market report for South East Asia that I promised you.
As we all know, last year was a difficult one. (1) *D*, since January things have been getting better. Sales have risen (2)____ 4% in China, our biggest market, and we are (3)____ to see continuing growth there. (4)____ the situation in Japan and Korea is not quite so promising, we are still likely to see an (5)____ in South East Asia overall, with Indonesia performing strongly.
In relation to the long term, we are optimistic. Our (6)____ is that economic growth in the whole region will begin to (7)____ from the start of next year. This will be (8)____ labour market and other structural reforms, as well as the fact that personal and corporate debt is now at a more manageable level. This growth in the economy will (9)____ many new opportunities for us, (10)____ we will face increasing competition from large international companies entering our market.

1	**A** So	**B** Even if	**C** Despite	**D** However
2	**A** for	**B** with	**C** by	**D** on
3	**A** possibility	**B** perhaps	**C** possible	**D** likely
4	**A** Although	**B** Nevertheless	**C** So	**D** As a result of
5	**A** recover	**B** improve	**C** improvement	**D** growing
6	**A** trend	**B** future	**C** prevision	**D** forecast
7	**A** steadily rise	**B** rise steadily	**C** rise steady	**D** rising steadily
8	**A** due to	**B** result of	**C** resulted from	**D** because
9	**A** create	**B** lead	**C** result to	**D** improve
10	**A** despite	**B** whereas	**C** so	**D** even though

Social media supplement

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Introduction

The main part of this book focuses on writing emails, but today people spend a lot of time writing on social media platforms as well. This short supplement introduces these platforms.

Text messages (SMS) and instant messaging (online chat)

You send text messages on a mobile phone (cellphone). A text message can be called simply a 'text'. Instant messaging (IM) is similar, but is online and often people reply immediately. SMS and IM both use a similar language – very informal, short forms, missing words etc.

IM started as a chat medium for friends sitting at their computers in the evening. Yahoo Messenger and Microsoft Messenger were the dominant platforms. Skype added the option of voice (like a telephone call) and live video. With the arrival of social media and smartphones, IM is developing into anytime, anywhere group chat.

Facebook

In the early days Facebook (FB) was used for posting text and photographs, for commenting on other people's posts, and for text-based chat. Now FB integrates the latest media-rich services alongside text and images.

It also tries constantly to enter the territory of the other platforms. For example it has professional groups to compete with LinkedIn, and photo-sharing tools to compete with Flickr and Picasa.

Google+

You can have multiple 'circles' of contacts within Google+ (G+). For example, you can keep your communications with personal friends and professional contacts separate.

It allows you to post photos and brief updates that are visible to anyone in the world, just to members of a particular circle, or to individuals. The integrated Google Hangouts allow you to have spontaneous multi-person video chats with members of a particular circle who happen to be online when you are.

LinkedIn

LinkedIn (LI) is a social networking site for professionals. You start by posting your CV/resume, then you build up a network of connections. You can let people know what you are doing and join professional groups. You can also look for jobs.

With LI you send messages to your connections just like email. There are also many discussions in the various professional groups, and here the writing style is more careful and structured than on other social media platforms.

A LinkedIn 'connection' is similar to a Facebook 'friend' or a Twitter 'follower'.

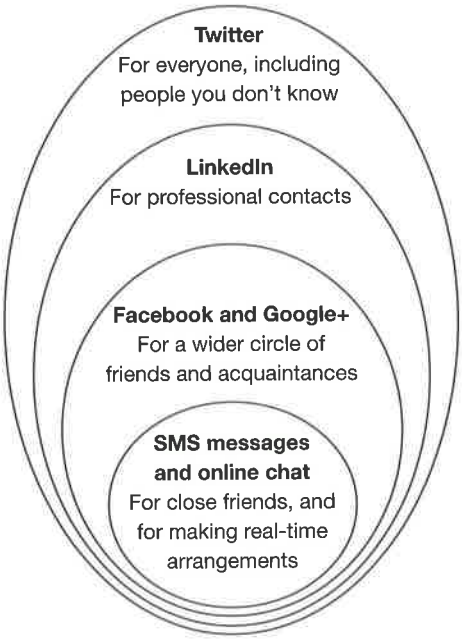
Twitter

Using Twitter you send very short messages known as 'tweets'. If you read an interesting tweet, you can retweet it to your followers. Conversations develop, and you can read these or join in at any time. Depending on who you follow, you can read tweets on almost any topic, from IM-style chat between friends, to comments on news events, to recommendations for interesting websites, to train companies updating passengers on delays.

You can search for a particular topic using a hashtag (#). This symbol is used to show key words in a tweet. There are also live hashtag chat sessions where all the tweets are on a particular topic, all including # and the topic name.

Looking at the different platforms

Any description of social media runs the risk of going out of date. But at the time of writing, the following was largely true:



Facebook ✓ Best for interacting at a more personal level. ✗ Having too many friends dilutes the genuine connections; can take over your life.

Google+ ✓ Best for having conversations with specific circles rather than everyone; good video conferencing tools. ✗ Fewer users due to late arrival on scene; unclear whether it's for friends (like FB) or professionals (like LI).

LinkedIn ✓ Best for showing others what you have done professionally, and for reading discussions on issues in your field. ✗ Misuse of discussion groups for promoting new products.

Twitter ✓ Best for short, focused updates to a wide audience, and for following hashtags on topical issues. ✗ Most tweets are read by very few people; some people who follow you just want to get noticed so that you follow them back.

Most platforms would like to get the market of the others. So FB would like to compete with LI for use by professionals. Similarly, G+ wants to compete with both LI and FB. There is also a strong tendency for the various platforms to converge – so if one introduces a new service then the others soon follow.

In any case, it is likely that much will have changed by the time you read this. In the social media world strategies and services develop all the time.

This supplement to *email English*

Writing on a social media platform is a little different to writing an email. This supplement first explores Facebook, Google+, LinkedIn and Twitter in more detail. Then it shows you over several pages how to write in a friendly, informal style that is appropriate for the online world.

You will find much in this supplement that is also relevant to emails, particularly informal non-business emails. And likewise, many units in the main part of the book are also relevant to social media.

Enjoy your writing! Have fun with social media!

Paul Emmerson, Worthing, UK, June 2012
www.macmillanenglish.com/authors

Platforms

Facebook

On Facebook (FB) you create a profile (timeline). This is like a webpage where you include your name, photo and information about yourself. To connect with other people on Facebook you first have to become 'friends' with each other.

Facebook is continually reinventing itself and adding features. The key feature however is the status update where you type a message and share it with your friends. This message can be a personal message (about what you are doing), a question, or a link to another website. All your friends see your status updates, and you can see theirs.

Other features of FB include the ability to create groups. These can be groups of friends, professional groups, groups of people with a common interest, etc. On FB you can also play online games with and against other people.

Facebook has various levels of privacy. Some of your information (name, profile photo) is visible to anyone searching FB, while other information is only visible to your friends.

Facebook also allows businesses and professionals to create FB pages. The difference between a Facebook page and a Facebook profile is that a page does not have friends – instead it has 'likes'. If you find a Facebook page of a brand, company or celebrity that you like, you can click on the 'like' button. You will then see their status updates on your profile page in your news feed.

Why use Facebook?

Because so many people have profiles on Facebook, it is sometimes the easiest way to find and contact a friend.

Having a profile on FB means:

- You can keep in touch with friends and family easily, as well as ask for advice or help from all your friends at once.
- You can share photos and news about your life without the need to send everyone an email.
- You can join groups of people with similar interests, or create a group about something you are interested in yourself. You make new friends that way.
- You can promote your business by setting up a Facebook page and giving special offers or information to those who 'like' you.
- You can publicize an event on Facebook (a party, or product launch, or conference) and invite people. It's an easy way for people to see things that are going on.

Tips on using Facebook

1. Complete your profile with the information you feel comfortable sharing with friends. Facebook offers you the possibility of sharing lots of information, but you don't have to let everybody know everything about you.
2. Update your status regularly. It will make your profile more interesting.
3. Add photos and videos to bring your profile to life.
4. Look around for Facebook groups.
5. If you have a business, think about setting up a Facebook Page and put aside time to regularly update it with news.
6. Think before you post, and make sure you check your account's privacy settings to control who sees what. Facebook keeps everything, and there are many stories of people posting photos or status updates that they later regretted!

Google+

On Google+ (G+), you create a profile with your name, photo and basic information such as where you live, where you went to school/university, and where you work. To connect with people, you add them to one of your 'circles'. If they belong to G+, they don't have to consent to be added to one of your circles, but they may receive a notification about it. You can have as many different circles as you want, so it might be a good idea to keep personal friends separate from work colleagues or people you know through a hobby or club. Circles are what differentiates G+ from other social media tools. Posting updates and photos is done in a way that is similar to Facebook, but in G+ you can choose who is able to see each item you post. You can make a post visible to the whole world, but it's probably better just to let people in one particular circle see it. If you have something more personal to post, you can even share it with just one person from a circle, so no one else will see it.

In addition to people who agree to be in one of your circles, you are also encouraged to 'follow' public figures and organizations. This just means that you add them to a circle called 'Following', so you will see updates that they post. This is like Twitter, but with people you follow being in a separate circle.

Another popular feature of G+ is the 'Hangouts', where you can easily start a video conference with people in your circles who have indicated that they are online and available for a Hangout. Currently, a Hangout can include up to nine people at a time and, in addition to video chatting, participants can watch YouTube videos simultaneously or sketch on a whiteboard.

Why use Google+?

As G+ becomes more widely known, more and more people will join and it will be easier to find friends there. There is also a tool you can use to invite your friends to join G+.

By adding G+ to your Google.com account, you can:

- Keep in touch with friends and classmates.
- Connect with colleagues while keeping them separate from personal friends, so maintaining a professional image.
- Use the Hangouts with friends for quick and easy video chats.
- Use the Hangouts with colleagues or clients for screen-sharing, collaborative editing (Google Docs), discussions and work sessions.
- Contact professionals from around the world who you may not be able to meet in person.
- Follow the activities of public figures and organizations that are important to you.

Tips on using Google+

1. Complete your profile with information that you feel comfortable sharing with the world, because it will be visible to everyone, and will be how people find you to connect with you.
2. Although you can move people in and out of circles easily, as soon as you add someone to a particular circle, they can see everything you've ever written and every photo you've ever posted to that circle. Be careful who you put in what circle.
3. Add posts regularly to keep it interesting, but only share them with the appropriate circles. Your boss may not be keen on finding out that you took a long lunch with friends, and your personal friends may not be interested in your congratulations to a colleague on a promotion.
4. Take advantage of the close integration of Google Docs with Hangouts. The existence of an office utilities suite in G+ is one thing that really separates it from the other platforms.

LinkedIn

LinkedIn (LI) is a social networking site for professional people. You first build an online CV/resume using the given LI format, and then build your network ('connections') starting with people you already know. You can invite other new people to join, and once someone has agreed to be part of your network, you can contact them directly. LI also suggests people you might like to connect with.

A key feature of LI is the different professional 'groups'. These can be very general (eg for all lawyers), or very specific (eg for lawyers in a specific town working in a specific area of law). You can join any group you want to, and read and contribute to the discussions there.

Another feature of LI is its Jobs section, and here you can apply for jobs that companies have advertised. An employer might also read your profile and contact you directly. You can also approach other individuals yourself to offer them work (very useful for freelancers).

There are also showcase pages for companies (like with Facebook) and you can follow individuals or companies (like with Twitter).

Finally, your LinkedIn and Twitter activity can be integrated, if you choose. Tweets can appear in your LI profile, and LI updates and posts can be tweeted.

Why use LinkedIn?

By having a profile on LinkedIn you:

- Increase your visibility and personal branding.
- Build trust. Through your connections, you show who you know. You can also ask for 'recommendations' where people will give personal testimonials about working with you.
- Direct traffic to your blog or website.

And as an active user of LinkedIn you can:

- Get in contact with professionals from around the world who you would normally never meet.
- Follow the discussions in the groups you have joined, and read expert opinion and debate there. You can also contribute yourself.
- Look for work, or show that you are available for different kinds of work.
- Research companies and individuals before you contact them, and after they contact you.
- Ask for advice, and get responses from people in your network.
- Contact people whose email address you don't know, or who have changed jobs.

Tips on using LinkedIn

1. In your profile, give attention to the summary and the photograph.
2. Ask for recommendations from your managers and colleagues.
3. In groups, join the conversation and don't be shy. Give ideas, opinions and information in a friendly, fun yet focussed way. Be responsive and interactive.
4. Join groups where your colleagues are, and also where your customers are.
5. Send occasional messages to your connections about things of benefit to them, such as news of professional events. In return you earn the 'right' to occasionally self-promote.
6. If you see a job you want to apply for, you can search for other people already in that company, then research their backgrounds and their posts to group discussions.
7. Continue to build and nurture your network even if your career is going well. You never know when or how you will need support in the future.

Twitter

Twitter is a website where you can post messages (called 'tweets') of up to 140 characters long. If people like your tweets, they can 'follow' you, and in this case all your tweets will appear in their timeline. In the same way, you get tweets from all the people you follow.

Once you have sent a tweet, there are several possible responses from other Twitter users. They might:

- Do nothing, because they never read your tweet in the first place. This is by far the most common situation because of the information overload on Twitter.
- Send you a message in response. This may be a tweet directed just at you, or may be a more general tweet that continues the conversation and is for everyone to read and respond to.
- Send you a (private) direct message. This will arrive by email as well as Twitter.
- Retweet your message. This means sending the tweet to their own followers.
- Follow you (if they are not already doing so).
- A combination of the above.

Why use Twitter?

With Twitter you can:

- Follow people you are interested in. At a personal level this may be a friend or a celebrity, or at a professional level it may be a thought leader or key player in your industry.
- Find information about a topic using the hashtag sign (#). For example, if you type '#esl' into the Search box you will see all (and only) tweets relating to English as a second language. But this example shows how the # must be used carefully, as '#esl' includes tweets aimed at both teachers and learners. You will soon find out the hashtags that are most relevant to you.
- Follow an event live, as it happens. So if you type '#election' you will see tweets relating to this topic. But again, this hashtag may not be the best: for example it may be too general (which election?). Of course you can also make a comment on the event yourself by using the relevant hashtag.
- Promote yourself or your company. For example if you update your personal blog, or your company is organizing an event, then you tweet it. You hope that these tweets will get retweeted and read by others.
- Find information by tweeting a question: someone may know the answer.
- Tweet to give personal news, just like other platforms. Or tweet that you are going to be somewhere at a particular time and ask who else will be there.

Tips on using Twitter

1 Spend time creating a good profile page. You don't know who will read this – it could be a potential employer.

2 Make your tweets interesting, focussed and relevant. And, surprisingly, the vast majority of tweets use full words – they are much easier to read.

3 Look for relevant hashtags. As a starter, try the one for your town.

4 If you want to build up followers, tweet often: several times a day. Remember that most tweets are only read by a few people.

5 Ask active Twitter users about which tools they use. There are many tools to separate the useful tweets from the 'noise'.

Writing for social media

Formality, tone and politeness

Look at these examples from emails:

1 Can you pick me up from the airport? My stuff weighs a ton. But if you're busy, don't worry – I'll take a taxi. See you Tuesday. Should be fun!

(informal, friendly)

2 Pick me up from the airport please. I have two heavy bags. We will meet on Tuesday as planned. I look forward to it.

(informal, but a little unfriendly)

3 Would it be possible for you to pick me up from the airport? I would really appreciate it. If it's not convenient, don't worry because I can easily take a taxi. I look forward to seeing you on Tuesday.

(formal, friendly, polite)

There are three issues here. One is formality (informal vs formal), another is tone (friendly vs unfriendly) and another is politeness (polite vs rude). These issues are closely connected but not the same. And there are strong cultural factors at play: example 3 above is friendly and polite in some cultures, but too indirect and insincere in others.

How do I write in an appropriate style?

There is no magic answer because it all depends on the speakers and the situation. However we can make some general comments:

Informal, friendly language. This style appears in social media and in emails between friends. It has informal words like *stuff*. It has lots of little words like *actually*, *anyway*, *just* and *really*. It has vague language such as *things like that* or *a couple of* (notice how the precise '*two bags*' in #2 above seems unfriendly). It uses exaggeration: things are *amazing* rather than *good*. It often misses out small words (see page 80). And it typically uses more words than necessary in order to express feelings and build the relationship.

Informal, unfriendly language. This style appears when the writer tries to be simple and direct, but in doing so is emotionally cold. It has commands rather than requests. It is too factual and precise. It lacks extra words that show feelings and enthusiasm. It fails to give choices.

Polite language. Look at example #3 above: *Would it be possible for you to pick me up …?* instead of *Can you pick me up …?* The formula at work is:

indirect language + more words = polite

Some people believe that this formula allows you to show respect, for example it allows the reader to save face (it is easier to say 'no'). But politeness is cultural, and other people find that indirect language is confusing and insincere – they think it is better to be simple, clear and direct. It is often said that indirect language is associated with the UK, Southern Europe and Asia, while direct language is associated with the USA and Northern Europe.

Another way to think of polite language is that it is like a letter rather than an email. In other words, it is a little more formal, has more fixed expressions, and shows a generally more careful use of language.

Business emails: situation and content

Many business emails are simple and direct. But the style may change because of the situation. Consider three emails describing a new product: one to your boss, one to a colleague, and one to a client. The relationships are different and so the emails will be

different. Style also depends on the content: an email on a serious matter is likely to be more formal, no matter who the reader is.

Short forms (text message language)

A text message can also be called a 'text' or an SMS. Text message language uses short forms mixed with slang. It is also found in online chat and on some social media platforms. It developed because of the difficulty of typing full words on small mobile phone keyboards.

SMS language can be broken down into these areas:

Words or sounds → letters or numbers

are → r	see you → cu
before → b4	thanks → thx
for → 4	tomorrow → 2moro
great → gr8	you → u
later → l8r	your/you're → ur

Common words → shortened

message → msg	very → v
please → pls	would → wd
regarding → re	your → yr

Expressions → first letters of words

ASAP → as soon as possible
BTW → by the way
FYI → for your information
OTOH → on the other hand
TIA → thanks in advance
BW → best wishes

Other ways to shorten words

There are other ways to shorten words:

- A slash (/) can replace missing letters, so *w/* means *with* and *w/e* means *weekend*
- & means *and*; @ means *at*

In fact, more or less any word or phrase can be shortened in social media writing if the context makes it clear:

No problem, I'll see you in 30 minutes.
→ No probs, c u 30 mins.

I'll meet Dan at the station on Wednesday.
→ I'll meet D at stn Weds.

I'm going to go back home now – I've got all the information I need.
→ Gonna go bk home. Got all info.

Short forms in context

Short forms like those above are found in text messages, online chat and social media. However they are not very common in emails.

Factors that affect the use of short forms include:

Age. The use of text message language is strongly age-related, with people born after about 1980 using it freely.

Situation. In a business context, use text message language with care. For example, BTW or BW are fine, but LOL ('laughing out loud') would never be used in a business context, despite being very common in social media.

Platform. On Facebook short forms are quite common as the medium is very informal. On LinkedIn very few short forms are found (professional people have to present an 'educated' image to the outside world). On Twitter the messages have a limit of 140 characters, and so you would expect to find many short forms here. However, the great majority of words in Twitter are written in full, and sentences are generally well-formed. It seems that Twitter users prefer the ease of reading a 'proper' full sentence.

Access to a full-sized keyboard. Given a full-sized keyboard, most people reduce their use of short forms. And even in text messages, short forms are becoming rarer due to new text input methods.

Missing out words

With text messages, online chat, social media and informal emails you can miss out some small words completely. In grammar this is called ellipsis.

But in business English it is usually not a good idea to miss out words (unless you are writing to a colleague you know well). You do not want any chance of misunderstanding. You want your message to be clear, unambiguous and easy to read.

Miss out *I*

The subject *I* can be missed out, especially with verbs like *hope*, *think* etc.

I hope you're well.
→ Hope you're well.

Miss out *I am / I have / I will*

The two-word phrases *I am*, *I have* and *I will* can be missed out when they are followed by a main verb.

I'm really enjoying the holiday.
→ Really enjoying the holiday.

I've bought the tickets.
→ Bought the tickets.

I'll see you later.
→ See you later.

Miss out *Do you / Did you / Have you*

In a question, the auxiliary verb and the subject *you* can be missed out.

Do you see what I mean?
→ See what I mean?

Did you enjoy the movie?
→ Enjoy the movie?

Have you had a chance to read it yet?
→ Had a chance to read it yet?

Miss out a form of *be*

Sometimes a form of *be* (*is/was/would be*) can be missed out if it is followed by an adjective.

I think next week would be better.
→ I think next week better.

This is particularly common in lists of short points, for example:

Supplier #2: cost high, quality good, delivery time acceptable.

Miss out *It/That/It's a/That's a*

The subjects *It* or *That* can be missed out, often with a form of *be* as well.

It could take longer than you think.
→ Could take longer than you think.

That sounds like fun.
→ Sounds like fun.

It's a great idea.
→ Great idea.

That's a pity – I was looking forward to it.
→ Pity – I was looking forward to it.

Miss out *the*

Sometimes the word *the* can be missed out.

What time is the meeting?
→ What time is meeting?

I just read the email about the contract.
→ Just read email about contract.

Missing out words in speech

Many examples on this page are also found in informal speech. But not all the examples on this page work well in speech. For example, the following would sound like beginner-level English, if spoken:

I think next week better.
Just read email about contract.

Bringing a sentence to life

In informal writing we use little words like *actually*, *really*, *just*, *well* and *anyway*. They show feelings, introduce your next point, or make a meaning stronger or softer. Look at how they bring a sentence to life:

1 a) *We had a great time.* (dead sentence)
   b) ***Actually**, we had a **really** great time.*

2 a) *It's a small problem.* (dead sentence)
   b) ***Anyway**, it's **just** a small problem.*

In all the examples on this page these little words could be missed out. But putting them in makes the writing friendlier.

actually

The word *actually* is used in several ways.

surprising but true (like *in fact* or *really*)

***Actually**, it's not very far. We could even walk.*
***Actually**, it's not that expensive.*

introducing something important

***Actually**, there's a problem with the contract.*
***Actually**, I need to speak to you about it.*

correcting the other person

***Actually**, it was Daniel not Leon who told me.*
***Actually**, she's Scottish not English. Be careful!*

And note that *actually* is a false friend in many languages. In English it does NOT have a time reference to now.

really

The words *really* and *not really* can be used to make an idea stronger or softer.

*It was **really** amazing.*
*Great! Let's do that. I **really** love Chinese food.*
*I **really** don't think that's a good idea.*
*I don't **really** like Bar Zero. What about …?*
*Either one is good. I don't **really** mind.*

just

The word *just* is used in many ways. You might know the first three, but look at the other two uses.

*I've **just** finished.* (*just* = a short time ago)
*It isn't **just** me.* (*just* = *only*)
***Just** as I expected!* (*just* = *exactly*)

just to make an idea softer

*I have to go to hospital – **just** a few days.*
*Don't worry, it's **just** a small thing.*

just to politely ask or tell something

*Can I **just** ask you something?*
*Sorry about last night. Can I **just** explain?*
*I **just** wanted to let you know that …*

well and *anyway*

The words *anyway* and *well* can be used in similar ways. They show a change in direction in your writing. In the examples below either word can be used.

responding with a statement

***Well**, I agree with you about the movie.*

asking a question

***Well**, what are we going to do now?*

continuing after a digression

***Well**, as I was saying, …*

concluding or summarizing

***Anyway**, it was great fun. After that we …*
***Anyway**, it was worth it. Next time I think I'll …*
***Anyway**, we need to talk more about it.*
***Anyway**, we can't do anything until we hear from them.*

preparing to close

***Anyway**, that's all for now. Speak soon.*
***Anyway**, I'll tell you more on Saturday.*

Being friendly

Friendliness is at the heart of social media, and in social media, friendly language is used with people you have never met. All the techniques on pages 79–85 help you to sound friendly when you write. Here are a few other ideas.

Questions

Before starting the main topic, ask questions in the first few lines you write. This shows interest in the other person.

Hi. How r u?
Stefan here. How's it going?
Hey Paula. What did u do at the w/e?
Wow! 3-1 to us. Did you see the match?

These are not real questions, and the other person can choose not to reply, or just to reply very generally.

Alternatively, you can start by giving your own news first and then ask a question.

I just got back from vacation. What about you? Did you go to Greece with Angela?

Sorry it's taken so long. Moved to another flat and been sorting things out. Any news? How about meeting up for a coffee?

Short, personal responses

We can respond to someone with a short, personal comment. After that we can add a follow-up comment or question. See the examples below.

pleasure

We can hv meal 2nite after movie.
→ ***Great.*** / ***Great idea.*** / ***Perfect.*** *Thx for org everything. Look fwd to it.*

Stronger expressions of pleasure are: ***Excellent!*** / ***Fantastic!*** / ***Wonderful!***

surprise

You'll never guess who I saw yesterday… Irina!
→ ***Really?*** / ***Wow!*** / ***Amazing!*** / ***You're kidding, right?*** ***What a surprise!*** *What happened?*

confirmation

Trying to find yr house. Am at big s/market on corner.
→ ***Good.*** / ***That's right.*** / ***Exactly.*** / ***Perfect.*** *Now left down Church St. I'm on right after 200m.*

Other standard responses include:

Congratulations! / *Great news!*
Really? / *That's interesting.*
Definitely. / *Absolutely.* / *Absolutely right.*
Definitely not. / *Absolutely not.*
Good luck! / *I'm sure you'll do really well.*
That's a pity. / *That's bad news.*

Short, funny, chatty comments

In the informal context of online chat, people often make short, funny, personal comments. They have little meaning but help to build the relationship. Below are some random examples. They could be used alone, or as the first part of a longer comment with more content.

Haha. Just read yr latest post. Great stuff!
Oh, c'mon. Surely u don't believe that?
Just uploaded the rest of my Vienna pics. Enjoy.
Great read, Phil! Keep up the good work.
Loved your post about online gaming. LOL.
Congrats Vicky. You deserve it!
Thanks! Skype this week? Time?
Great to see u yesterday. Btw, loved your shoes!

Being polite

The most common way to be polite in writing is to use indirect language. This language is diplomatic: it avoids strong opinions, it gives choices, and it allows the other person to save face.

could, would

We use *could* and *would* to soften a request or suggestion. The words *perhaps*, *possibly* and *just* can also be added.

Compare:

Please speak to Nicola about this.
→ **Could** *you* **possibly/just** *have a word with Nicola about this?*

Can u get here b4 six?
→ **Wd** *it b poss 4 u to get here b4 six?*

When we try to persuade people, the negative form *couldn't* is more indirect than *can* or *could*.

Couldn't *you do it tomorrow instead?*
Couldn't *we go somewhere else?*

mind

To make a request, use *Would you mind* + *-ing*.

Would you mind *giving me a hand on Thursday? I'd really appreciate it.*

To ask for permission for yourself, use *Would you mind if I* + past tense.

Would you mind if I *arrived late? I have another appointment that I can't cancel. Sorry about that.*

If you think you might inconvenience someone, you can use *If you don't mind*.

***If you don't mind**, I won't come with you tonight. I'm a little tired.*

think, hope, wonder

We often use these verbs for polite requests (*Can you…?*) and permission (*Can I…?*). Compare:

Can you find out what time it starts?
→ ***Do you think you could** find out …?*

Can I bring a few friends with me?
→ ***I hope you don't mind if I** bring …*
→ ***I wonder if I could** bring …*

We can use all three verbs in the past continuous tense to be very polite.

Can I leave the meeting early?
→ ***I was thinking of** leaving the meeting early, if that's okay with you.*

Can we have a chat at some point?
→ ***I was hoping we could** have a quick chat at some point.*

Can we rearrange the meeting?
→ ***I was wondering if** we might rearrange the meeting.*

I don't think …

We often use *I don't think …* to be diplomatic.

Compare:

You sounded really tired on the phone. **We shouldn't** *go out tonight.*
→ *You sounded really tired on the phone.* **I don't think we should** *go out tonight.*

Mike's been offered a job but **he doesn't want** *it.*
→ *Mike's been offered a job but* **I don't think he wants** *it.*

I'm sorry but … / I'm afraid

The phrase *I'm sorry but* to soften bad news is well-known. In British English the phrase *I'm afraid* is also common. Don't forget to give a reason.

***I'm sorry but** it's not going to be possible. The reason is …*
***I'm afraid** it's not possible. It's because …*

Being vague

The word 'vague' means 'not precise' or 'not exact'. Vague language is more friendly and relaxed; precise language is more cold and inflexible.

I think, I guess, I reckon

A simple way to be vague is to use *I think*.

Are u going 2nite? ***I think*** *it starts 7:30.*
I'm tired. ***I think*** *I might stay in tonight.*

In the above two examples the writer is sure, but using *I think* ... sounds more friendly. We can also use *I guess* and *I reckon* when we are nearly sure, but not 100%.

I reckon *it wd b better to wait till nxt wk.*
Madelina didn't reply to my text. ***I guess*** *she's not interested.*

thing, things, stuff

The word *thing* is a very common vague word.

There's ***a thing*** *at work I have to sort out.*
Let's wait and see how ***things*** *develop.*
Hi! How are ***things*** *over in Poland?*

The word *stuff* is a common alternative to *things*, and very informal.

By the time I got there, all the good ***stuff*** *had gone.*
Yeah, whatever, I know all that ***stuff****.*

sort of, kind of

The words *sort of* and *kind of* can mean 'type of':

What ***sort of*** *conversation did you have?*
What ***kind of*** *car does he drive?*

But they are also used in vague language:

Things are ***sort of*** *difficult between us.*
Sorry I left early – I was feeling ***kind of*** *ill.*

a little, a bit

If we say *very* + adjective it can sound too strong.

So we often say *a little* or *a bit* instead. The meaning here is close to 'very', and is not literally 'a little'.

It's ***a little*** *expensive.*
I thought he was ***a bit*** *rude.*
It's ***a little*** *late to call him – I'll do it tomorrow.*

Alternatives to *will*

The word *will* used alone sounds very fixed and certain. It helps if you use a contraction (*'ll*), and there are many vague phrases to refer to the future:

I will be there at 7.
→ *I'll* ***probably*** *be there* ***around*** *7.*
→ ***Hopefully*** *I'll be there at 7.*
→ *I* ***should be able to*** *get there by 7.*

Time, prices, quantities

With informal writing we often use vague language for time, prices, etc. It would sound strange to use an exact number.

Let's meet after work, ***about/around*** *six.*
It'll only take ***a couple of*** *minutes.*

It costs ***about/around/roughly*** *€200.*
It costs ***just over/just under*** *€200.*

Can you call me tomorrow? There are a ***couple of/one or two*** *things to discuss.*
Next week is going to be difficult – I've got ***loads of*** *work to do.*

We exaggerate time and numbers in a vague way to make our writing more interesting.

I was waiting ***for ages****.*
It took me ***all day*** *to do that spreadsheet.*

There were ***hundreds of/thousands of/millions of*** *people waiting there.*

Making longer posts and comments

On sites such as LinkedIn you can comment on group discussions. Here you should write more carefully as your words might be read by anyone in your professional field.

Start with the conclusion

The standard way to build an argument is to have your conclusion (your own point of view) at the end. The problem with this is that people read very quickly online and may not have the patience to get to the conclusion. So consider putting your conclusion first (after some thanks and points of agreement) and then give the reasons afterwards. Here is an example:

Thanks for posting this, Sandra. It's a great piece and you raise some very important issues. I like your points about … and … . However, I have a different opinion about … I think that … Here are my reasons. First, … And second, … But these are only small points; in general I agree with you and I really enjoyed reading your post.

If you disagree more strongly, think twice before writing. Any strong opinion of yours will be met by an equally strong reaction from others. So you risk becoming unpopular. On the other hand, if you believe something passionately, then go ahead and post. You may become an opinion former yourself! The internet is an open medium where people can argue freely, and it is fun to read a variety of points of view. Just make sure that your post is well-argued (with a logical structure and concrete examples) and not personal. Under no circumstances write in anger.

Build your argument

You can be a little more formal when writing a longer comment for a professional audience.

For example:

and → *In addition/Moreover*
but → *However/On the other hand*
so → *Therefore/As a result*
because → *The reason for this is*

Other linking words and phrases that you will find useful are:

I think / I believe / I am convinced that
First(ly) / Second(ly) / And finally
Clearly / Of course
In general / On the whole
In fact / Actually
For example / eg / such as
In particular
Alternatively
So basically / So what I'm trying to say is
In relation to / With regard to

Remember to use a comma after linking words that begin a sentence:

In general, I agree that … However, I think that …
In particular, I have noticed that … In addition, it is clear to me that … Therefore, I believe that …

Finally, note these two tips:

1 **Write short sentences.** In your language, sentences are probably more complicated than in English. So simplify. Break a long sentence into two short sentences. It will make your writing easier to understand even if the grammar is not perfect. And consider numbering points or using bullets.

2 **Use a 'topic sentence' at the start of each paragraph.** In good writing the first sentence of a paragraph is often a 'topic sentence'. This introduces the ideas in the rest of the paragraph, and makes the argument easier to follow. You will find examples in any magazine-style text or any report.

Phrase bank index

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Basics

	More formal	More informal
Name	Dear Mr/Mrs/Ms Dupuis Dear Mary	Hi Mary Mary, … (*or no name at all*)
Previous contact	Thank you for your email of … With reference to your email sent [date], … I apologize for not getting in contact with you before now.	Thanks for your email. Re your last email, … Sorry I haven't written for ages, but I've been really busy.
Common acquaintance	Your name was given to me by …	I got your name from …
Reason for writing	We are writing to inform you that … I am writing in connection with … In reply to your email, here are …	Just a short note to let you know that … I'm writing about … Here's the … you wanted.
Giving information	I'm writing to let you know that … We are able to confirm that … We would like to point out that … You will be pleased to hear that … We regret to inform you that …	Just a note to say … I can confirm that … Please note that … Good news! Unfortunately, …
Attachments	Please find attached my report. I'm sending you … as a pdf file.	I've attached … Here is the … you wanted.
Asking for information	Could you give me some information about … I would like to know … I'm interested in receiving/finding out …	Can you tell me a little more about … I'd like to know … Please send me …
Requests	I would be grateful if you could … I wonder if you could … Do you think I could have …? Thank you in advance for your help.	Please … /Can you …? Could you …? Can I have …? I'd appreciate your help on this.
Promising action	I will … I'll investigate the matter. I will contact you again shortly.	I'll … I'll look into it. I'll get back to you soon.
Offering help	If you wish, I would be happy to … Would you like me to …?	If you like, I can … Do you want me to …?
Final comments	Thank you for your assistance. Do not hesitate to contact us again if you need any further information. Please feel free to contact me if you have any questions. My direct line is …	Thanks for your help. If there's anything else, just let me know. Just give me a call if you have any questions. My number is …
Close	Give my regards to … Looking forward to our meeting. Yours/Sincerely	Best wishes to … Speak to you soon/See you soon. Best wishes/All the best

Checking understanding

Technical problems	Did you get my last email sent on …? Sorry, you forgot to attach the file. Can you send it again? I got your email, but I can't open the attachment. Did you mean to send this? I don't want to open the attachment in case it's got a virus.
Asking for clarification	I'm not sure what you mean by this. Could you clarify? Which … do you mean? Sorry, I don't understand this point. Can you explain in more detail? Are you sure about that?
Giving clarification	Sorry, what I meant was …, not … I thought …, but I may be wrong. I'll check and get back to you. The correct information is given below. Please amend your records accordingly. Sorry, forget my last email. You're right.
Close	I hope this clarifies the situation. Get back to me if there's anything else.

Negotiating with external partners

Asking for information	What are your usual charges (fees/rates) for a job like this? Can you give me some more information about …?
Requests	Do you think you could …? Would you be able to …?
Emphasizing a point	My main concern at this stage is … The main thing for me is …
Asking for a suggestion	How do you think we should deal with this? What do you think is the best way forward?
Making a suggestion	Why don't we …? What about if we …?
Negotiating: being firm	I understand what you're saying about …, (but …) I can see what you're saying about …, (but …)
Negotiating: being flexible	I would be prepared to … (if you …) I am willing to … (if you …)
Negotiating: agreeing	Okay, I'm happy with that for now. That's fine. Let's go ahead on that basis.
Next steps	I'll be in touch soon. Let's talk next week.
Closing	I look forward to working with you. I'm sorry that we couldn't use your services this time, but I hope there will be another opportunity.

Arrangements

Meetings

	Neutral	Informal
Reason for writing	I'm writing to arrange a time for our meeting. What time would be convenient for you?	Just a quick note to arrange a time to meet. When would suit you?
Suggesting time/place	Could we meet on [day] at [time]?	How about [day] at [time]? Are you free sometime next week?
Saying when you are (are not) free	I would be able to attend the meeting on Thursday morning. I'm out of the office until 2pm. Any time after that would be fine. Unfortunately I can't manage next Monday.	I'm free Thursday am. I won't be around until after lunch. Any time after that is okay. Sorry, can't make it next Monday.
Confirming	I'd like to confirm … That's fine. I will call/email you tomorrow to confirm the details.	Thursday is good for me. That should be okay. I'll get back to you if there's a problem.
Changing arrangements	This is to let you know that I will not be able to attend the meeting next Thursday. I wonder if we could move it to …? I apologize for any inconvenience caused.	Re our meeting next week, sorry but I can't make Thursday. How about … instead? Sorry for the inconvenience.
Close	I look forward to meeting you in Brussels. Let me know if you need to change the arrangements.	See you in Brussels. Give me a call if anything changes.

Invitations

Inviting	I would like to invite you to attend … Your presence at … will be very useful. Please let me know if you are able to attend.	I'm writing to invite you to … It would be great to see you there. Please let me know if you can make it.
Preparations	Before the meeting it would be useful if … It would be helpful if you could bring …	Please … before the meeting. Please bring to the meeting …
Accepting	Thank you for your kind invitation. The date you suggest is fine. I would be delighted to attend the meeting.	Thanks a lot for the invitation. The date's fine for me. I'd love to come to the meeting.
Refusing	Thank you for your kind invitation. Unfortunately, I have another appointment in my schedule on that day. I hope we will have the opportunity to meet on another occasion in the near future. I am sure the meeting will be a great success.	Thanks a lot for your kind invitation. Unfortunately, I have something else on that day. Please accept my apologies. I hope we can meet up soon. Good luck with the meeting.

Writing styles

Formal/Informal

	Neutral/Formal	Informal
Example phrases	Thank you for your email of 12 Feb.	Thanks for the email.
	With reference to …	Re …
	I would be grateful if you could …	Please …
	We regret to advise you that …	I'm sorry to tell you that …
	Please accept our apologies for …	I'm sorry about …
	I was wondering if you could …	Could you …?
	We note from our records that you have not …	You haven't …
	We would like to remind you that …	Don't forget …
	It is necessary for me to …	I need to …
	It is possible that I will …	I might …
	Would you like me to …?	Shall I …?
	However, … /In addition, … /Therefore, …	But, … /Also, … /So, …
	If you require any further information, please do not hesitate to contact me.	If you'd like more details, just let me know.
	I look forward to meeting you next week.	See you next week.
Example words (formal/informal pairs with the same meaning)	assistance/due to/inquire/inform/information	help/because of/ask/tell/facts
	occupation/possess/provide/receive/repair	job/have/give/get/fix
	request/requirements/verify	ask for/needs/check

Polite

	Neutral	Polite and diplomatic
Requests	Can you …?	Could you possibly …?
	Please …	I was wondering if you could …?
Asking for permission	Is it okay if I …?	Would it be a problem for you if I …?
	Could I …?	I wonder if I could …?
Offering help	Can I …?	Would you like me to …?
	Shall I …?	Do you need any help with …?
Making a suggestion	What about … (+ *-ing*)?	Why don't we …?
	Shall we …?	Perhaps we should …?
Softening a strong comment	There is a problem.	There seems to be an issue with this. It's nothing serious.
	There will be a delay.	I'm sorry, but it looks like there will be a small delay.
	It will be very expensive.	It might be quite expensive.
		Won't it be a bit expensive?
		It won't be cheap.
	We can't do that.	I'm not sure we can do that.
	That gives us very little time.	Actually, that doesn't give us much time.
	I think it's better to ask Liyu.	Wouldn't it be better to ask Liyu?
	I disagree.	I can see what you're saying, but …
		Don't you think that …?
		To be honest, I think it might be better to …

Commercial

Request for information (customer)

How you got the contact	We met last Thursday on your stand at the Munich Trade Fair. I am emailing you via your website, which I found through Google.
Reason for writing	We are a manufacturer/supplier/provider of … . We are interested in … We are a Polish company exporting to the rest of the EU, and we need …
General requests	We would be grateful for some information about … Please send us information about your product range and prices.
Specific requests	In particular, we would like to know … Please send details of your prices, discounts, terms of payment and delivery times. Could you also say whether there is any minimum order?
Close	An early reply would be greatly appreciated. I look forward to an early reply, and am sure that there is a market for your products here in Brazil.

Giving information (supplier)

Thanks	Thank you for your email of 4 June inquiring about …
Factual information	We can quote you a price of … We can ship by … [date] The goods will be shipped within three days of a firm order. We can offer a discount of 5% on orders over €5000. We require payment by bank transfer/letter of credit. Our normal procedure is to … Our normal terms for first-time customers are … We can supply the items you require directly from stock.
Attachments	I am attaching a document that gives full details of … I am attaching our current catalogue and price list as a pdf file.
Highlighting key points	You will see that our line of … is on special offer right now. This month we are offering a special deal on …
Answering questions	We can meet all your needs. Our experience in this field includes … We ship the goods within 24 hours of a firm order, and for first-time customers our minimum order is $2,000. I am sorry but that model is no longer available. However, …
Close	May I suggest that I call you at your convenience to discuss the matter further? If you need any further information, please do not hesitate to contact me. My direct line is …

Following up a call (supplier)

Open	Thank you for your call this morning, and for explaining your needs so clearly. I understand you are looking for … and I am confident we can find a good solution.
Information	I have attached some information about our company, including … I have attached a list of some of our clients, which include [names of companies].
Next steps	As agreed, I'll give you a call in a day or two after you've had a chance to read … Perhaps it would be a good idea to meet in person to discuss …?
Close	In the meantime, if you would like to discuss any other points, please don't hesitate to call me on my direct line, given below.

Clarifying issues (customer)

Open	Thank you for sending … . We are interested in … . However, there are one or two things we would like to clarify before going ahead.
Discussing terms	Do you give any discount for large orders? If we pay 50% in advance, can we pay the rest after 60 days? We need these items by … at the latest.
Close	If we can reach an agreement on these matters we are sure that we can do more business with you in the future. We look forward to hearing from you soon.

Agreeing terms (supplier)

Open	Thank you for your email of … inquiring about a possible order for … .
Saying *yes*	In relation to …, we would be happy to let you have … I have spoken to my line manager, and we are able to … on this occasion.
Saying *yes, if you …*	With regard to …, unfortunately we are not able to … . However, I am sure we can find an acceptable compromise. We are happy to give you ... if you …
Final details	We would be grateful if you could supply bank references. Please complete and return the attached form so that your order can be processed without any delay. Please note that we have recently improved the functionality of our website, and it is now possible to place an order online.
Close	I will give you another call later in the week to check that everything is satisfactory. We look forward to receiving your order, and assure you it will have our prompt attention. If you need any further information, do not hesitate to contact me.

Making an order (customer)

Open	Thank you for your recent email, and we accept your quotation. Our completed order form is attached, and we have instructed our bank to open a letter of credit.
Close	Please acknowledge receipt of this order.

Confirming an order (supplier)

Open	Your order has been received. We can confirm that your goods have been shipped. Due to exceptional demand these items are temporarily out of stock. We hope to be able to ship your order within … days. We will keep you fully informed and apologize for any inconvenience this may cause.
Close	We are confident that you will be very satisfied with the goods. Should there be any questions, please do not hesitate to contact me, either by email or phone.

Asking for payment (supplier)

First reminder (open)	We are writing regarding a payment of €12,600 for invoice number KJ678. This is now overdue. A copy of the invoice is attached. According to our records, the sum of €4,500 is still outstanding on your account.
(action)	Please send the money by bank transfer to settle the account, or give an explanation of why the balance is still outstanding. If you have already dealt with this matter, please disregard this email. We would appreciate your cooperation in dealing with this matter as soon as possible.
Second reminder (open)	On [date] I wrote to you regarding your company's unpaid account, amounting to €4,500. May we please remind you that this amount is still outstanding. I wish to draw your attention to my previous email of [date] about the overdue payment on your account. We are very concerned that the matter has not received your attention.
(action)	We need a bank transfer in full settlement without further delay. Clearly, this situation cannot be allowed to continue, and we must ask you to take immediate action to settle your account. If you have any questions, do not hesitate to contact me. Thank you for your cooperation.
Final demand (open)	Following my emails of [dates] I must inform you that we have still not received payment for the outstanding sum of €4,500. I wrote to you on [dates] regarding the balance of €12,600 on your account. I attach copies of both emails. This sum is now two months overdue. We are very concerned that the matter has not received your attention.
(action)	Unless we receive payment within seven days, we shall have no alternative but to take legal action to recover the money. In the meantime, your existing credit facilities have been suspended.

Complaints and apologies

Complaining (customer)

Open

I am writing …
… in connection with my order FS690 which arrived this morning.
… to complain about the quality of a product I bought from your website.
… to complain about the poor service we received from your company.
… to draw your attention to the negative attitude of some members of your team.

Complaint

Our order dated 16 September clearly stated that we wanted 600 items. However you sent …
The goods were faulty/damaged/in poor condition.
There seems to be an error in the invoice.
The equipment I ordered has still not been delivered, despite my phone call to you last week to say that it is needed urgently.
The product I received was well below the standard I expected.
To make matters worse, when I called your company your staff were rude and unhelpful.

Request for action

Please replace the faulty goods as soon as possible.
We must insist on an immediate replacement/full refund.
Unless we receive the goods by the end of this week, we will have no choice but to cancel the order.

Close

I hope you will deal with this matter promptly as it is causing considerable inconvenience.

Apologizing (supplier)

Open

I am writing in relation to your recent complaint.

Apologizing

I was very concerned to learn about … Please accept my sincere apologies.
I would like to apologize for the inconvenience caused.

No responsibility

We appreciate that this has caused you considerable inconvenience, but we cannot accept any responsibility in this matter.

Promising action

We will send replacement items/send the missing goods/give you a refund immediately.
I need to look into this. Please leave it with me and I'll get back to you tomorrow.
I have looked into the matter and …
I have spoken to the staff involved, and …
We're having a temporary problem with … . We're doing everything we can to sort it out.

Compensation

To compensate for the inconvenience, we would like to offer you …

Close

Thank you for bringing this matter to my attention.
Once again, I hope you will accept my apologies for the inconvenience caused.
I can assure you that this will not happen again.
I very much hope you will continue to use our services in the future.
If you have any further questions, please do not hesitate to contact me on my direct line …

Personal

Opening and closing: some examples

Sorry I haven't been in touch. Really busy with all kinds of stuff.	⇨	Anyway, that's all for now. Are you on Skype? Let's fix a time to chat.
Thank you so much for the wonderful present. It's exactly what I wanted. How did you know?	⇨	Thanks again for the gift, and give my very best wishes to your family.
I've just read your email. I'm so sorry to hear about what happened.	⇨	You know you can count on me if you need any support. I'll call you at the weekend to see how things are.
Really sorry, but I can't make it at the weekend. Such a shame because I was looking forward to it.	⇨	Sorry again I can't come. But let's meet up soon anyway. What about going to see that new Ang Lee movie?

Being friendly: linking words at the start of a sentence

You heard something, but are not sure	It seems that/Apparently
Surprising, but true	Actually/In fact
Obvious or already known	Obviously/Of course
Bad/Good fortune	Unfortunately/Luckily
What you really think	To be honest/If you ask me
Most important thing about a situation	Basically/At the end of the day
Changing the subject, or returning to it	Anyway/So
Preparing to close	Anyway

Asking for advice

	Neutral/Formal	**Informal**
Open	I'd like your advice about a problem I have.	There's something on my mind.
Asking for advice	I was wondering if you had any ideas.	What should I do? Any ideas?
Close	I would appreciate it if you could contact me to discuss this matter further.	Please let me know what you think. You can email, or give me a call.

Giving advice

	Neutral/Formal	**Informal**
Open	I was sorry to hear about your current difficulties.	I'm real sorry you're having such a hard time at the moment.
Giving advice	I think it might be a good idea to … Have you thought of … (+ *-ing*)?	I think you should … What about … (+ *-ing*)?
Options	I think this option would be preferable to …	I think it's better than …
Close	I hope I have been of some help.	Hope that helps.

Suggestions

Making a suggestion	I think we should/Let's … Shall we/Perhaps we could/Why don't we …? I suggest/How about … (+ *-ing*)
Accepting	Great! What a wonderful idea! Yes, good idea. I think it would work really well. Yes, that might be worth trying. Let's give it a go.
Rejecting	Your idea sounds good, but I'm not sure it would work in practice. I'm not so sure about this. I can see some problems.

Special situations

Thanks	Just a quick note to say many thanks for … It was really helpful and I really appreciate it.
Good luck wishes	Good luck with … I'm sure you'll do well. I wish you every success with your future projects.
Congratulations	Many congratulations on your promotion/new job. I was delighted to hear the news about … Well done! You worked hard for this and really deserve it.
Sending wishes to a third party	Please give my best wishes/kind regards to …
Bad news	I was so sorry to hear about … I've just heard about your illness/unfortunate accident. I am so sorry. Hope you feel better soon. If there's anything I can do to help, just let me know.

Job application

Greeting (formal)	Dear Mr/Ms [real name]/Dear Hiring Manager for [position]/To whom it may concern
Reason for writing	With reference to your advertisement on the … website, I am interested in applying for …
Your background	I am … years old and am currently studying for a degree in … at … University. For the last two years I have been working as a [job] at [name of company].
The job itself	I am interested in this job because … I think I would be very well suited for this job as I …
Refer to CV/resume	I have attached my CV as a Word document. You will notice in the CV that I …
Final comments	I would be grateful for the opportunity to discuss my application further with you. I am available for interview by telephone or Skype any weekday afternoon. Should you require any additional information, please don't hesitate to contact me. You will find my telephone number, email address and Skype name below.
Close (formal)	I look forward to hearing from you soon. Yours faithfully/Yours truly

Reports

Report structure

Introduction/Background	Here is my report, as requested by the Board at their meeting of 18 April. The purpose of this report is to consider/analyze/review … The report is based on research done/figures collected/interviews made … I have divided the report into three sections.
Findings	As can be seen in table 1/section 2/figure 3, … The graph/table shows that … It appears that … . This has led to a situation where … I will discuss this in more detail below/in section 3.2.
Conclusion/Recommendations	The findings/figures/results/investigations show that … It is clear that we are in a situation where … My specific recommendations are as follows.
Closing comments	Please look at the full report, attached as a pdf, and let me have your comments. Feel free to contact me at any time if you have any questions.

Linking words

Sequence	Firstly/Secondly/Finally
Talking generally	In general/On the whole/Typically
Contrast	However/Nevertheless/On the other hand
Avoiding generalization	In general …, however … /On the whole …, but …
Avoiding certainty	It is possible (likely) that/It appears that/The evidence suggests that
Adding another point	In addition/Furthermore/On another point
Examples	For example/For instance/eg
Important example	Especially/Above all/In particular
Surprising but true	In fact/Actually/As a matter of fact
Something obvious	Clearly/Obviously/Of course
Result/Consequence	As a result/Therefore/For this reason
Rephrasing	In other words/That is to say/ie
Alternatives	Either … or … /Alternatively/Instead of
New topic	In relation to/With reference to/As far as … is concerned
Summarizing	In brief/In short/So, to sum up
Concluding	On balance/Taking everything into consideration/In the final analysis

Trends

Movement	Sales went up/rose/improved/peaked/increased/grew/were up/were variable Sales went down/fell/got worse/hit a low/decreased/shrank/were down/were stable
Size of movement	Sales went up … slightly/marginally/significantly/substantially
Speed of movement	Sales went up … slowly/gradually/steadily/rapidly

Prepositions	Sales went up *from* 15,000 *to* 17,500. So they increased *by* 2,500. Last year we had a market share *of* 14%. After the recent increase *in* sales it now stands *at* 18%.
Forecasts	I'm sure that/I expect that/I doubt that … sales will increase. Sales will definitely/definitely won't increase. Sales will probably/probably won't increase. Sales are likely to/are not likely to increase. Sales may/might increase.
Cause and effect	The marketing campaign should create/lead to/result in an increase in sales. The increase in sales was because of/resulted from/was a result of/was due to the marketing campaign. Next month will be the start of the marketing campaign. So/Therefore/Because of this we should see an increase in sales.
Contrast	Sales increased. However/Nevertheless, market share was unchanged. (like 'but') Sales increased, although/even though market share was unchanged. (surprise) Market share was unchanged in spite of/despite the increase in sales. (surprise) Sales increased, while/whereas market share was unchanged. (strong contrast, no surprise)

Answer key

1 Formal or informal?

A

1 *d* 2 g 3 a 4 e 5 b 6 h 7 f 8 c 9 o 10 n 11 k 12 p 13 l 14 m 15 j 16 i

B

1 c 2 f 3 a 4 h 5 l 6 b 7 g 8 e 9 k 10 i 11 d 12 j

C

Email 1

Sorry, I can't make it on Friday. As I'll miss the meeting, could you send me a copy of the minutes? I'll write to Rina as well, to tell her (that) I won't be there. Once again, I'm really sorry about this.

Email 2

Thanks for your email (of 25 Jan) where you asked for help on how to get an online discount. I need to know your a/c number before I can deal with this. Please also let me know which browser you're using.

Email 3

I'm writing re your order number 8916. We got the order this morning via our website, but you haven't filled in the section about size. What do you need? These products are selling very well, and I'm sorry to tell you that the medium size is temporarily out of stock. But we're expecting more to arrive soon. Shall I email you when they are back in stock?

2 Key phrases

A

Email 1 Meeting 14/5 **Email 2** Your order #8694: out of stock items **Email 3** Action re contract **Email 4** Special deals for January! **Email 5** Shipping confirmation

B

1 *Re your last email*
2 Just a short note to let you know that …
3 Good news!
4 I can confirm that …
5 Sorry for …
6 Unfortunately, …
7 Please …
8 *Can you …?*
9 Do you want me to …?
10 If you like, I can …
11 I'll get back to you.
12 I've attached …
13 Thanks for your help.
14 If there's anything else, just let me know.
15 Looking forward to …
16 Regards/Best wishes

C

more formal

3 Opening and closing

A

1 c 2 g 3 b 4 h 5 d 6 f 7 a 8 e

B

1 5*d* 2 1c 3 7a 4 4h 5 8e 6 6f 7 2g 8 3b

C

1 *end/form*
2 end/inf
3 beg/form
4 beg/inf
5 end/form
6 end/inf
7 beg/form
8 end/inf
9 beg/inf
10 beg/form
11 end/form
12 beg/inf

D

a) *3*, 10 **b)** 1, 5, 6, 7, 11 **c)** 4, 8, 9, 12 **d)** 2

4 Giving news

A

1 form 2 inf 3 inf 4 form

B

1 I'm writing to confirm our appointment on Tuesday 6 June (*or* June 6).
2 Hey Max. You'll never guess what's happened!
3 You will be pleased to hear that your application has been successful.
4 Unfortunately, I will not be able to make the meeting on Tuesday 6 June (*or* June 6).
5 We regret to inform you that your application has not been successful.
6 Just a quick note to say that everything's good for our trip at the weekend.
7 Here's an update on the project.

C

a) 2, 6 **b)** 1, 4 **c)** 3, 5 **d)** 7

D

1 *Further*
2 confirm/say
3 make/attend
4 forward
5 reference/regard

6 let
7 unfortunately
8 attached

E

1 *b* 2 c 3 a 4 f 5 d 6 e

F

1 *d* 2 c 3 c 4 a 5 d 6 a 7 c 8 c 9 d 10 b

5 Advice and suggestions

A

a) 3 b) 5 c) 2 d) 6 e) *1* f) 8 g) 7 h) 4

B

In general a)–h) are more formal.

C

1 *you can*
2 should I
3 me know
4 such a
5 it might
6 you could
7 be preferable
8 I have

D

1 *a* 2 c 3 b 4 a 5 d 6 b 7 a 8 g 9 e
10 i 11 f 12 h

E

1 wondering, could
2 let, appreciate
3 should, better
4 about, might/could/would
5 Shall, about
6 worth, work

6 Invitations and directions

A

Email 1

1 Dear Natalia
2 We would be very pleased if you could come
3 It has been arranged
4 in order to
5 Your attendance will be very welcome.
6 it will not be necessary to
7 Refreshments will be provided
8 Your presence at the meeting will be very useful.
9 will be able to attend
10 as soon as possible.
11 John Saunders

Email 2

12 Thank you for your kind invitation.
13 I would be delighted to attend
14 I am sure it will be very useful.
15 Would it be possible
16 Thank you once more for your invitation
17 I look forward to seeing you

Email 3

18 I'm writing in relation to your kind invitation.
19 Please accept my apologies for being unable to attend.
20 let me have a copy of any report arising from the discussion.
21 we will have the opportunity to meet on another occasion in the near future.
22 I am sure that the meeting will be a great success.

B

1 would, could
2 presence/attendance, useful/welcome, make/manage
3 let, know, as
4 kind, delighted/pleased/happy, seeing/meeting (Note: we only say *meeting* in this phrase if we haven't met the person before)
5 Unfortunately, appointment/meeting/commitment, apologies
6 opportunity/chance, near, success.

C

1 c 2 b 3 e 4 f 5 a 6 d

D

1 get/come
2 by
3 turn
4 on
5 until
6 miss
7 past
8 at
9 give
10 lost
11 Anyway
12 wishes/regards

7 Checking understanding

A

1 attachment
2 mean
3 Which (*or* What)
4 Let
5 sure (*or* certain)
6 check
7 wrong (*or* mistaken)
8 back

B

1 *Did you mean to send this? I don't want to open the attachment in case it's got a virus.*
2 Are you sure about that? I thought the conference was in Bodrum.
3 I'll check and get back to you later today.
4 Sorry, I don't understand this point. Can you explain in more detail?

5 I'm not sure what you mean by this. Could you clarify?
6 I thought the meeting was on Thursday, but I may be wrong.
7 Sorry, forget my last email. You're right. It should be Thursday, not Friday.
8 What I meant was we can't transfer the money until Monday. I hope this clarifies the situation.

C

1 attached
2 know
3 think
4 forgot
5 again (*or* now)
6 sure
7 mean
8 wrong
9 get (*or* come)
10 detail
11 course
12 send (*or* get)

8 Verb forms

A

1 b) *present simple*
2 d) present continuous
3 f) present perfect
4 c) present perfect continuous
5 a) past simple
6 e) past continuous

B

Present simple
at the moment, every Friday, nowadays, once a year, right now

Present continuous
at the moment, nowadays, right now

Present perfect
already (BrE), just (BrE), not … yet (BrE), over the last few months, since, so far this year

Past simple
already (AmE), in the old days, just (AmE), last week, not … yet (AmE), one month ago, when I was young

C

1 recruit
2 'm planning
3 need
4 've always been able to
5 're operating
6 have fallen
7 means
8 hope

D

1 've just received (BrE) *or* just received (AmE)
2 need
3 've given out
4 had
5 distributed
6 want
7 've already contacted (BrE) *or* already contacted (AmE)
8 think

E

1 haven't been
2 met
3 was waiting
4 was
5 didn't recognize
6 was wearing

F

1 've been trying
2 've been waiting
3 Have you found
4 've decided
5 've been eating
6 've started
7 've been going

Note for F: the past simple is not given as an option in the instructions. However, in American English 3 could be *Did you find*, 4 could be *decided*, and 6 could be *I started*.

9 Sentence building

A

1 You may remember me. We exchanged business cards at the Trade Fair last week.
2 Our advertising campaign is going well. We should consider extending it until June.
3 I am writing to ask about the availability of rooms in July. I need a single room for three nights.
4 I am going to see my parents next weekend (*or* Next weekend I am going to see my parents). I haven't seen them for a long time.

B

1 I am writing to let you know that I am coming to visit your offices in Moscow next month.
2 This will be part of a visit that I am making to all our subsidiaries in Eastern Europe.
3 I will take the opportunity to consult with you about our strategic plan for Eastern Europe, which we have been working on for some time.
4 I would also like to visit our production facility while I am in Moscow, and if there is time, some of the local suppliers to that facility as well.
5 I will contact you again as soon as I know the exact dates when I can travel.

C

Email 1

I am writing to thank you for your hospitality during my recent trip to Paris. The meetings were very productive, and I am sure that they lay the basis for a good long-term business relationship.

As well as the business side of things, I really appreciated the time you took to show me Notre Dame, and the wonderful meal that we had afterwards. The next time that you are in Munich it will be my pleasure to return your kindness.

Please give my regards to your colleagues in the Paris office, it was a great pleasure to meet them all.

Email 2

Thank you for taking the time to attend an interview with us last week. Unfortunately, we have to inform you that your application has not been successful.

As we mentioned in the interview, we had many applicants for this position and the standard of candidates was very high. While we were impressed with your interview, we did not feel that you have the necessary skills and experience for the position.

We appreciate your interest in working with us, and we would like to take this opportunity to wish you every success in the future.

10 Missing out words; abbreviations

A

1 *b*, f 2 e, i 3 c, h 4 a, d, j 5 g

B

It was a great evening wasn't it! I really enjoyed the meal, and it was nice to see Mary and Roger again. Have you had a chance to speak to Lucy yet? Don't worry if you haven't, I will be seeing her tomorrow.

About next week – the film you suggested sounds great. I've been talking to some colleagues at work about it. Tuesday might be difficult. Perhaps Wednesday would be better? Let me know.

Sometime soon we need to talk about holiday plans for next summer. Things are still a bit uncertain at work. It might be possible to take two weeks off in July, but I can't be sure.

I'm going to my parents at the weekend – I'm looking forward to it. They live in Chichester. Have you ever been there?

Anyway, I've got to go now. I hope you're well.

I'll see you next week.

C

1 b 2 a 3 d 4 c

D

Email 1

Subject: *Your order reference number KD654*

In relation to your order received today, we cannot supply the quantities you need right now. Please confirm as soon as possible if a part-delivery would be acceptable, with the rest to follow later. Regards, Stefan

Email 2

Subject: Thanks for your message

Regarding your message left on my voicemail – yes, I'm free for lunch Wednesday next week. By the way, good news about your job interview. Have to work now. See you, Jane.

Email 3

Subject: Technical Support

Sorry I missed your call. In relation to (*or* Regarding) technical support, on the website we have a Knowledge Base and extensive list of Frequently Asked Questions. You should find what you want there. But if you do need to speak to somebody, you can call me during normal working hours. Best wishes, Alan.

11 Common mistakes 1

A

1 *I am writing*
2 ~~until Friday~~ by Friday
3 ~~I will be~~ I would be
4 ~~attach~~ attached
5 ~~I am agree~~ I agree
6 ~~we can to meet~~ we can meet
7 ~~so soon as~~ as soon as
8 ~~I been~~ I've been
9 ~~more better~~ better (*or* much better)
10 ~~don't can help~~ can't help
11 ~~informations~~ information
12 ~~to meet~~ to meeting
13 ~~I am really~~ I really
14 ~~the follow~~ the following
15 ~~still~~ yet

B

1 reference to your
2 you for sending
3 inform you that
4 able to confirm
5 apologize for the
6 appreciate it if
7 get back to me
8 would be convenient
9 you would like
10 I'll write
11 meet you at the
12 hearing from you
13 a copy of the
14 invitation to visit
15 reference to your

16 Being polite and diplomatic

A

1 *Would you mind* / I was wondering if you could
2 I wonder if I could / Would it be a problem for you if I
3 Would you like me to / Would it help if I
4 Perhaps we should / Why don't we

B

1 looks like, small
2 seems, nothing serious
3 honest, might
4 can see, don't
5 Actually, doesn't, much
6 Wouldn't
7 What, about
8 might, quite, won't, cheap

C

1 I wonder (*or* was wondering) if we could meet again next week?
2 There seems to be a mistake on the invoice.
3 The quality is not very high.
4 Would you like me to speak to Mr Baker?
5 Your estimate for the cost might be a little low.
6 Wouldn't it be a better idea to wait?
7 To be honest, I'm not sure it's a good idea.
8 Perhaps we should think about cancelling the project.

D

1 saying, what about
2 won't (*or* wouldn't), little
3 honest, sure, convenient
4 mean
5 don't, would, better

a) 1, 4, 5 b) 3 c) 2, 5 d) 1

E

1 *It seems to be*
2 quite/a bit/a little
3 Wouldn't it be/Won't it be
4 we haven't been very happy
5 Perhaps we should/Why don't we
6 I was wondering if you could
7 It's a bit/a little delicate
8 I might/may be
9 I'm not sure (that) it's a good idea
10 seem a little/seem to be a little/might be a little
11 Don't you think
12 would/might

17 Information

A

1 Please send
2 would, possible
3 advance, help
4 full, details
5 need
6 hesitate

B

1 following up
2 little more
3 particular
4 attached
5 background
6 Get back

C

1 I'm writing about …
2 (Mrs Tanaka Yui) gave me your name.
3 Please send me …
4 *I'd like to know a little more about …*
5 Thanks for your help.
6 Just let me know if you have any questions.
7 Speak to you soon.
8 Thanks for the email – info you want is attached.

D

more formal

E

1 Your name was given to me by
2 I would be grateful if you could send me
3 Thank you in advance for your assistance (*or* If you need any more information, please do not hesitate to contact me)

18 Action

A

1 c 2 f 3 b 4 d 5 a 6 e 7 h 8 j 9 g
10 l 11 i 12 k

B

1 willing
2 appreciate
3 right away
4 anything else
5 take care
6 handle
7 check
8 leave
9 sort out
10 get back

C

1 b 2 e 3 a 4 c 5 f 6 d

D

1 find out, figure out, draw up
2 look into, sort it out, get back to

E

1 ~~an advice~~
2 ~~milestones~~
3 ~~puts~~
4 ~~explain~~
5 ~~scope~~
6 ~~liabilities~~
7 ~~although~~

8 ~~interesting~~
9 ~~long time~~
10 ~~say me~~

19 Memos and short messages

A

(No answer needed)

B

1 Situation
Mr Bianchi of Ferrara Textiles will be looking around the company tomorrow, from about 11.30.
2 Objective
It is important to make a good impression.
3 Strategy
Please:
1 Inform all staff in your department.
2 Remind them to greet Mr Bianchi by name and take time to answer his questions.
3 Arrange lunch breaks so that there is always someone available in your section.
4 Closing comment
Thank you for your cooperation.

C

Model answer:
Subject: Training course
I have found some information about a computer training course. I think it would be useful for someone from our department to attend. The details are as follows:
Course: Spreadsheets for Financial Planning.
Dates: 4 June–8 June
Times: 18.00–19.30 every evening
Cost: €750
I am available and would like to go. Would it be possible for the company to pay?
Thank you.

D

Model answer:
Subject: Mrs Alonso's retirement
As you may know, Mrs Alonso will be retiring at the end of the year. She has been with the company for 20 years. We would like to organize a leaving party for her, and present her with a small gift. Claudia will be coming round if you want to make a contribution.
The party will be after work on 20 December, in the main conference room. Everyone is welcome.

20 Arranging a meeting

A

1 ~~be convenient~~
2 ~~one time~~
3 ~~at, on, on~~
4 ~~can~~
5 ~~return to you~~
6 ~~for, could be~~
7 ~~occupied, regret for~~
8 ~~I'm afraid but, control~~
9 ~~a promise~~
10 ~~What if, in place~~
11 ~~take it ahead~~
12 ~~matter~~
13 ~~see~~
14 ~~telephone~~
15 ~~compliments~~

B

1 on/next/–
2 in
3 would
4 regards
5 sorry
6 make/manage
7 away/busy/out
8 How/What
9 instead
10 able
11 would
12 seeing/meeting
13 call/ring
14 any

C

1 *b* 2 e 3 d 4 a 5 f 6 c

D

1 Are we still okay for Thursday?
2 I need to finalize arrangements today.
3 can we reschedule for the following week?
4 something urgent has come up.
5 I'll circulate the agenda in the next few days.
6 let me know if you want to make any changes.

E

1 *'re going*
2 're catching
3 will be
4 're staying
5 're meeting
6 'll take
7 're not doing/aren't doing
8 'll have
9 I'll forward

21 Negotiating with external partners

A

1 *Can*
2 would, could
3 could
4 need to
5 should
6 would
7 would

8 could
9 should
10 might
11 would
12 need to
13 would
14 couldn't

B

1 c 2 f 3 i 4 d 5 h 6 b 7 g 8 a 9 j 10 e

C

1 *What are your usual charges for a job like this?*
2 How do you think we should deal with this?
3 Why don't we
4 My main concern at this stage is
5 Do you think you could
6 I'll be in touch soon
7 I would be prepared to
8 I understand what you're saying about
9 That's fine. Let's go ahead on that basis.
10 I look forward to working with you.

22 Commercial: customer/supplier sequence

A

1 e 2 d 3 f 4 c 5 b 6 a
i) 1, 4, 6 ii) 2, 3, 5

B

1 *an inquiry*
2 information
3 a quotation
4 the quotation
5 an order
6 an invoice (with the goods)
7 a payment
8 a receipt
9 a complaint
10 the issue

C

1 *b* 2 a 3 f 4 d 5 c 6 h 7 e 8 g

D

1 *supply*
2 advertisement
3 acknowledge
4 value for moneyd
5 standard
6 terms
7 apologize
8 remind

23 Commercial: inquiries and orders

A

a) *Inquiry 2*
b) Reply 2
c) Inquiry 5
d) Inquiry 4
e) Reply 1
f) Reply 3
g) Inquiry 3
h)Inquiry 1
i) Reply 5
j) Reply 4

B

1 *c* 2 a 3 e 4 b 5 d
1 b 2 e 3 d 4 c 5 a

C

1 *attached, delay*
2 grateful, references
3 first-time, pre-payment
4 discount, repeat
5 goods, firm
6 assure, attention
7 quotation, credit
8 processed, track
9 records, outstanding
10 stock, supplies
11 apologize, inconvenience
12 amend, accordingly

24 Commercial: discussing terms

A

1 d 2 g 3 a 4 c 5 h 6 f 7 b 8 e
9 an order 10 an offer 11 an agreement
12 a compromise

B

Email 1

1 *list*
2 pieces
3 order
4 discounts
5 size
6 prepared
7 credit
8 invoice
9 references
10 latest
11 reach
12 well-known

Email 2

13 relation
14 regard
15 first-time
16 compromise
17 accounts
18 procedure
19 ahead
20 stock
21 place

22 fill
23 give
24 deal

C

1 for
2 in
3 on
4 with
5 on
6 by
7 on
8 on
9 for
10 to
11 of
12 for
13 ahead
14 in
15 on
16 over
17 from
18 within

25 Commercial: asking for payment

A

1 *I wish to draw your attention to my two previous emails.*
2 There is an overdue payment on your account.
3 We are concerned that the matter has not yet received your attention.
4 This situation cannot be allowed to continue.
5 We must urge you to take immediate action to settle your account.
6 We have still not received payment for the outstanding sum.
7 We shall have no alternative but to take legal action to recover the money.
8 We would appreciate your cooperation in resolving this matter.

B

First reminder: email 2
Second reminder: email 4
Third reminder: email 3
Final demand: email 1

C

1 a 2 b 3 a 4 b

D

1 *concerning a payment*
2 should have been paid
3 settle your account
4 have still not received
5 without further delay
6 please do not hesitate
7 two months overdue
8 shall have no alternative

26 Job application

A

1 *b* 2 g 3 i 4 f 5 *n* 6 k 7 j 8 *d*
9 c 10 l 11 *e* 12 m 13 a 14 h

B

Possible paragraph structure:
To whom it may concern. //
With reference to your advertisement on the JobFinders website, I am interested in applying for the post of tour leader for Turkish school students. //
I am 26 years old and am currently studying for a diploma in Tourism at Izmir University. When I finish I hope to follow a career in the travel industry. During the last few summer vacations I have worked as a youth leader in Turkey, and I enjoyed the work very much. //
Next summer I would like to do something more varied and challenging, and for this reason I am applying for the job advertised, leading groups of young people on trips to London. I think I would be very well-suited for this job as I have a lot of energy and enthusiasm, and I am also responsible and reliable. //
I have attached my CV as a Word document. You will notice in the CV that I have supervized children on a range of sports and cultural activities over the last few years, as well as dealing with administrative matters such as transport arrangements and tickets. You will also see that I have achieved very high grades in spoken English at university. //
I would be grateful for the opportunity to discuss my application further with you, and am available for interview by telephone or Skype any weekday afternoon. //
Should you require any additional information, please don't hesitate to contact me. You will find my telephone number, email address and Skype name below. //
I look forward to hearing from you soon. //
Yours sincerely //
Evrim Kemal //
Tel: +90 (0)473542543 //
Email: evrim-kemal@yahoo.com //
Skype: evrim-kemal

C

1 to, on, in, for
2 as
3 for
4 as
5 on
6 to, from
7 of, at
8 for, in
9 in
10 at (*or* for)
11 as
12 for

27 Complaints

A

1 *connection*, *attitude*
2 matter, inconvenience
3 delivered, urgently
4 purchased, standard
5 attention, issue
6 replace, goods
7 terms, treatment
8 entitled, replacement
9 package, ordered
10 unless, cancel
11 quality, purchased
12 refund, escalate

B

1 f 2 g 3 a 4 c 5 b 6 h 7 e 8 d

C

1 *connection*
2 urgently
3 escalate
4 refund
5 faulty
6 standard
7 terms
8 attention
9 replacement
10 inconvenience

D

1 *Furthermore*, In addition
2 *In particular*, Specifically
3 Finally, Firstly
4 However, On the other hand
5 Even though, In spite of the fact that
6 As a result, Therefore
7 Actually, In fact
8 In conclusion, Taking everything into consideration (*or* Finally)

E

1 *Firstly*
2 However
3 Furthermore
4 Specifically
5 In fact
6 in spite of the fact that
7 As a result
8 In conclusion

28 Apologies

A

Email 1

1 *on behalf of*
2 unprofessional conduct
3 Please accept my sincere apologies for
4 You have my assurance that
5 resolve the matter to your satisfaction
6 to compensate for the inconvenience caused
7 regarding the incident
8 If I can be of further assistance
9 do not hesitate to contact me

Email 2

1 *for*
2 unfortunate behaviour
3 I'm really sorry for
4 You can be sure that
5 put things right
6 to say sorry
7 about what happened
8 If there's anything else I can do
9 please call

B

1 g 2 j 3 f 4 c 5 b 6 a 7 i 8 h 9 d 10 e

C

1 ~~*absolutely*~~
2 ~~material~~
3 ~~wares~~
4 ~~out of work~~
5 ~~an inflammation in our warehouse~~
6 ~~sort out it~~
7 ~~restore them~~
8 ~~disadvantage~~

D

1 Thank you very much for bringing this matter to my attention.
2 I was very concerned to learn about the problems you experienced.
3 I will look into the matter and get back to you within the next few days.
4 Once again, please accept our apologies for the inconvenience caused.
5 Having looked into this matter in detail, I regret that I can be of no further assistance.

29 Reports: structure and key phrases

A

1 b 2 d 3 a 4 e 5 c

B

1 e 2 d 3 a 4 f 5 c 6 b 7 h 8 j 9 g
10 k 11 l 12 i
Introduction/Background: *1*, *2*, *3*, *4*
Findings: 5, 6
Conclusion/Recommendations: 7, 8, 9
Closing comments: 10, 11, 12

C

1 purpose of this report
2 summary
3 partially due to

4 focused on
5 as follows
6 smaller budget
7 easily achievable
8 how to proceed
9 let me have your comments
10 Feel free

30 Linking words and relative clauses

A

Point 1 *In general*, However, in addition, As a result
Point 2 In relation to, Nevertheless, Obviously, On another point
Point 3 In particular
Point 4 Firstly, Secondly, In fact, Alternatively
Close especially

B

1 *Secondly / Finally*
2 On the whole / Typically
3 Nevertheless / On the other hand
4 Furthermore / On another point
5 Above all / In particular
6 Actually / As a matter of fact
7 Obviously / Of course
8 For this reason / Therefore
9 As far as … is concerned / With reference to
10 In short / So, to sum up

C

1 We interviewed three candidates who were all very good.
2 The three candidates that we interviewed were all very good.
3 The workers who we need to lay off are listed below.
4 The sales team whose results were particularly good should be given a bonus.
5 Our market share is now around 22%, which is 2% more than last year.

31 Describing trends

A

1 **a)** *go down* **e)** decrease
b) fall **f)** shrink
c) get worse **g)** be down
d) hit a low **h)** be stable
2 **a)** *rise* **b)** improvement **c)** growth
3 **a)** *slowly* **d)** significantly
b) sharply **e)** gradually
c) slightly **f)** steadily
4 **a)** *gradual improvement* **b)** slow growth
c) slight rise
5 **a)** from, to, by **b)** of, in, at
c) since, for

B

1 *at*
2 rose
3 to
4 of
5 steady
6 growth
7 for
8 rapidly

C

1 will definitely
2 might/may
3 I'm sure
4 I expect
5 I doubt
6 b 7 c 8 a

D

1 likely
2 at
3 well
4 might
5 uncertain
6 I expect
7 significantly
8 will probably
9 probably won't
10 are going to have

32 Explaining trends

A

1 lead to / result in
2 resulted from / was a result of / was due to
3 Because of this / Therefore

B

1 such
2 so
3 as a result
4 due to
5 led to
6 because
7 Therefore
8 because of

C

1 although
2 Even though
3 whereas, while
4 spite, despite
5 fact that
6 However, Nevertheless, Even

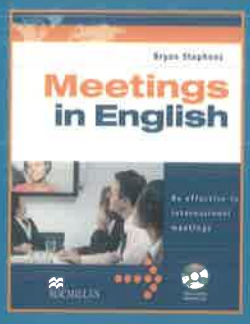
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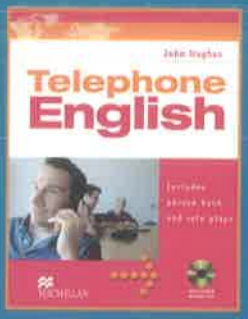
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9 A 10 D

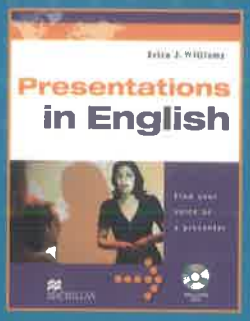
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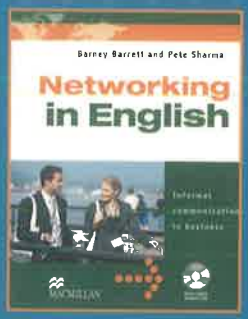
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